



SMART



ENGLISH

Multi-skill Course in English

Name

Class Section



8

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PREFACE



'English Reader' a new series of English text books comprising of eight books from I to VIII **following the pattern of NEP 2020**. The series has been designed keeping in view the modern teaching, innovative and need-based learning of English at the primary and junior level. The main aim of the series is to guide the beginners in the proper way of understanding by giving them the knowledge of the basic and elementary concepts of English language.

The approach of these books is child oriented and activity based. These are designed to promote language development through various skills like comprehension, word building, written work, communication and discussion.

The texts included in the series have been carefully selected and graded. These are value-based and offer topics to suit every taste and interest. Special emphasis has been laid on the preservation of our rich heritage and the protection of the environment.

Exercises set at the end of each lesson will engage the students individually or in pairs or groups. It will instil in them the habit of independent thinking and also give them an equal opportunity to express their views, ideas and opinions. New words have been introduced in each lesson and their use explained with a view to enhance the vocabulary power of the students. It will encourage the students to use dictionary for learning new words and will also familiarise them with minute grammatical aspects of the language.

We sincerely believe that our efforts will be appreciated both by the teachers as well as the learners. Suggestions, if any, for improvement of the series will be thankfully acknowledged and incorporated in subsequent editions.

—Author & Publisher



NATIONAL EDUCATION POLICY (NEP) 2020



UN SDGs

Ensuring the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are supported and met by 2030.



COGNITIVE CAPABILITIES

Developing cognitive capacities (illiteracy, numeracy, critical thinking and problem solving).



The **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, as envisaged by the **Ministry of Education**, provided high quality education and educational opportunities to India that has more than one-third of its population under 20. The importance of **NEP 2020** for such a critical demographic group cannot be emphasised enough.

EXPERIMENTAL LEARNING

Learning by doing, nurturing rational thought and action, compassion and empathy, courage and resilience and developing a scientific temper.



EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Developing social, ethical, and emotional capacities and dispositions.

CLARITY OF CONCEPT

Emphasising on conceptual clarity, understanding in detail rather than rote learning.



CREATIVITY

Developing creative imagination with sound morals and ethical values.



TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Through Integrated Solutions
Promoting the extensive use of available technology to make learning more immersive.

MULTILINGUATION AND CULTURE

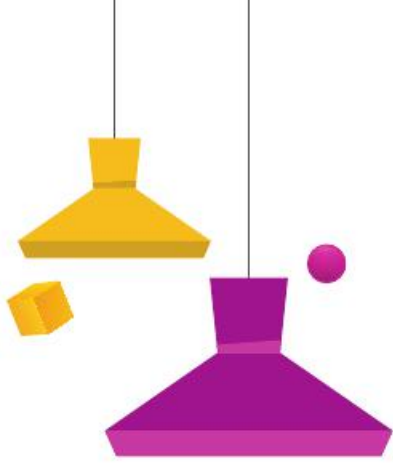
Promoting learning multiple language as understanding India's heritage and other.



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1

Why I Am Not A Painter

I am not a painter, I am a poet.
Why? I think I would rather be
a painter, but I am not. Well,

For instance, **Mike Goldberg**
is starting a painting. I drop in.
'Sit down and have a drink', he
says. I drink; we drink. I look
up 'You have' SARDINES in it.'
'Yes, it needed something there.'
'Oh!' I go and the days go by
and I drop in again. The painting
is going on, and I go, and the days
go by. I drop in. The painting is
finished. 'Where's SARDINES?'
All that's left is just
letters, 'It was too much', Mike says.

But me? One day I am thinking of
a color : orange. I write a line



about orange. Pretty soon it is a whole page of words, not lines. Then another page. There should be so much more, not of orange, of words, of how terrible orange is and life. Days go by. It is even is prose, I am a real poet. My poem is finished and I haven't mentioned orange yet. It's twelve poems, I call it ORANGES. And one day in a gallery I see Mike's painting, called **SARDINES**.

—Frank O'Hara



New Words to Learn



Sardines : a type of fish; the title of one of Goldbers paintings; **Mike Goldberg** : an American abstract expressions painter, friend of the poet.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- Do you think the poet feels that he has created a work of art or is he making fun of painters and their paintings?
 (a) Yes ☐ (b) No ☐ (c) None of these ☐
- Who was starting a painting?
 (a) Frank O'Hara ☐ (b) Mike Goldberg ☐ (c) Only (a) ☐
- What is 'Sardines'?
 (a) It's a ship ☐ (b) A type of fish ☐ (c) Only (b) ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. I am not _____ .
Why? I think _____
_____ not. Well.
2. For instance, _____
_____ drop in
'Sit down _____
_____ says.

C. Answer the following with reference to context :

1. I write a line about orange :
 - (i) Where does the poet get the idea to write about this subject?
 - (ii) Is what he writes in verse or in prose?
 - (iii) How much does he write?
 - (iv) What is unusual about what he writes?
2. I drop in :
 - (i) Who drops in and where?
 - (ii) How is the speaker greeted?
 - (iii) What does the speaker notice when he looks up after this?

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. What reaction does the poet have when he hears what Mike is painting?
2. Does the painting take a short time or long time to complete? How do we know?
3. What does the poet wish to be?
4. Why does the artist say he is painting?
5. What does the painting contain in the end?
6. In what way is the poem similar to the painting?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

A. Punctuation

Analyse

Punctuate the following to make it sensible :

I saw a peacock with a fiery tail

I saw a blazing comet drop down hail

I saw a cloud with ivy circled round
 I saw a sturdy oak creep on the ground
 I saw a pismire swallow up a whale
 I saw a raging sea brim full of ale
 I saw a Venice glass sixteen foot deep
 I saw a well full of mens tears that weep
 I saw their eyes all of a flame of fire
 I saw a house as big as the moon and higher
 I saw the sun even in the midst of night
 I saw the man that saw this wondrous sight



B. Spelling :

Correct the mistakes in the following, if any :

- | | | | |
|----------------|-------|-----------------|-------|
| 1. tigre | _____ | 2. leafs | _____ |
| 3. rockry | _____ | 4. croocked | _____ |
| 5. shruberries | _____ | 6. strawberries | _____ |
| 7. kenell | _____ | 8. fountane | _____ |
| 9. newspaper | _____ | 10. openning | _____ |
| 11. somber | _____ | 12. sailers | _____ |
| 13. innoscent | _____ | 14. solitary | _____ |
| 15. mockry | _____ | | |

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- Complete these well-known similies :

Example : 'as brave as a lion.'

- | | | | |
|-----------------|-------|------------------|-------|
| 1. as bright | _____ | 2. as brittle | _____ |
| 3. as brown | _____ | 4. as changeable | _____ |
| 5. as dead | _____ | 6. as deaf | _____ |
| 7. as different | _____ | 8. as fair | _____ |
| 9. as fat | _____ | 10. as fierce | _____ |
| 11. as fit | _____ | 12. as happy | _____ |
| 13. as gaudy | _____ | 14. as harmless | _____ |
| 15. as heavy | _____ | | |

LET'S WRITE

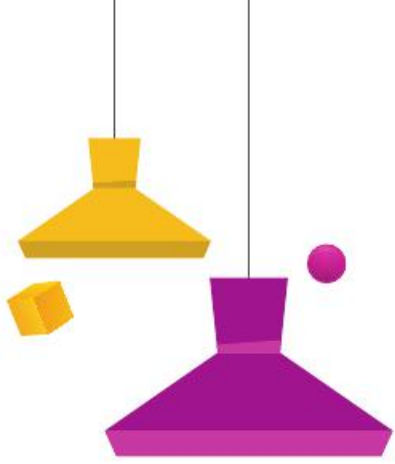
- Using the style adopted by O'Hara in the poem, write a short poem or a piece of prose on one of the following topics : Writing Skills

1. a conversation with a friend about his/her habits
2. a strange photograph
3. visitors

Activity Time



- Search from Internet or take the help of your school library and paste the picture of O'Hara : Art Integration



2

Equine Therapy

Equine therapy can help special children improve their coordination and concentration. It is a forty-year-old horse-riding therapy prescribed for people with disabilities.

It's a Saturday and Pushpa P Bopaiah has been on her feet all day. She has thirty-two children with disabilities, who come to her for riding lessons. Yes, Pushpa is a therapist and her classes begin at six in the morning.

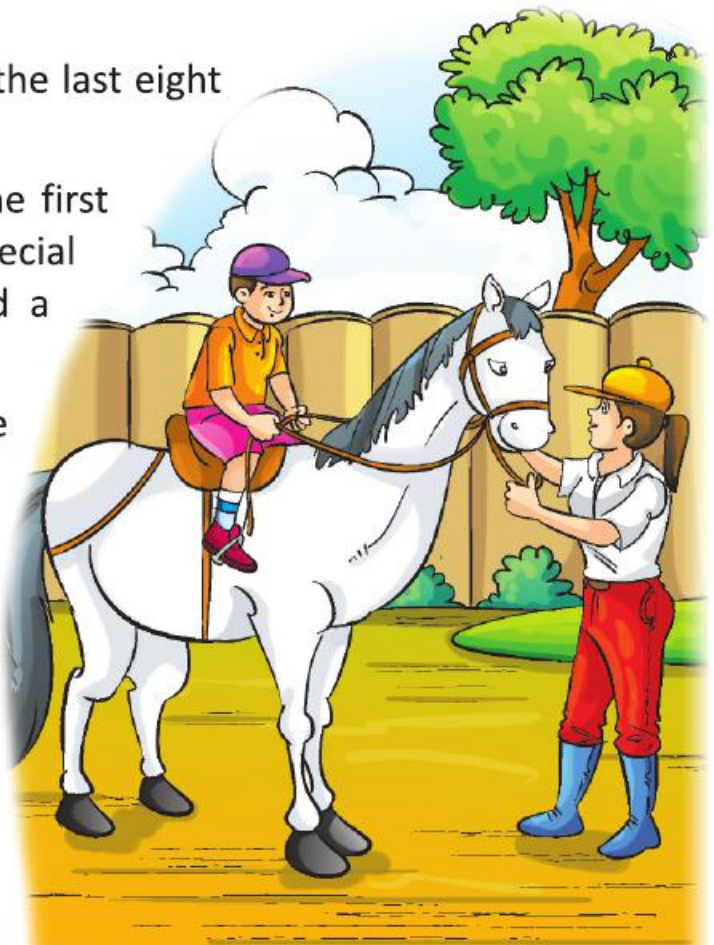
She has been helping special children for the last eight years.

She still remembers the stares she got the first time when she walked into a school for special children, dressed in breeches, boots and a helmet.

"People asked me whether I was off to the races," she recalls.

She had to repeatedly clarify that she was a qualified therapist and not someone who was addicted to horse riding. She had gone to assemble the first batch of students who had enrolled for her equine therapy classes.

"Children are more receptive to equine therapy because they interact with a live



animal and are in the midst of nature,” says Bopaiah, herself a keen rider. Children with multiple disabilities have sought therapy at Bopaiah’s centre.

“Horse riding has positive effects on the behaviour of disabled children. It also helps to tone up their muscles and improves their appetite,” says Bopaiah, who has trained in equine therapy at the Special Equestrian Riding Therapy Centre, California, USA.

When seven-year-old Shubhajeet Roy started riding his favourite mare, Saraswati, a year ago, he couldn’t sit straight on the horse. “He would cry constantly, not concentrate and not talk,” recalls Bopaiah. That’s history now. Shubhajeet freely chats with Bopaiah as she takes him around the ground and lets him bond with Saraswati. “His concentration and hand coordination have improved dramatically,” says Bopaiah.

Bopaiah draws a customized lesson plan for every child and chooses a horse according to her/his individual needs. Thirteen-year-old cerebral palsy patient Varsha Rao is among Bopaiah’s first and most regular students. Varsha couldn’t speak, so Pushpa learnt sign language to communicate with her. After eight years of training, Varsha has gained confidence, learnt to sit upright, and has developed a love for animals. This is one therapy session that Varsha doesn’t to be forced to attend.

–The Telegraph

New Words to Learn



equine therapy : a treatment that can help in anxiety or depressions; **disabilities** : a state of being unable.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- Equine therapy is meant for _____ .
 - children who do not perform well in games
 - children who have physical or mental disabilities
 - children who want to become horse racers



2. What do you think is sign language?
 - (a) A language where you have to sign before you are allowed to use it.
 - (b) A kind of language which you can only write.
 - (c) A way of communication with people who cannot hear, by using movement of hands.
3. This text is about _____.
 - (a) how animals like horses can help in the treatment of special children
 - (b) Pushpa is a very good horse rider
 - (c) a horse is very familiar to children
4. Who helped Shubhajeet Roy get better?
 - (a) Equine therapy
 - (b) Puspha Bopaiah
 - (c) Both Saraswati, the mare and Puspha Bopaiah

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. _____ can help special children improve their coordination and concentration.
2. Pushpa has been helping special children for the last _____ years.
3. Pushpa had to repeatedly _____ that she was a _____ therapist.
4. Children with multiple _____ have sought therapy at _____ centre.
5. Shubhajeet Roy started riding his favourite mare _____, a year ago.

C. Write T for true and F for false statements :

1. Puspha Bopaiah is a horse rider. _____
2. Pushpa does not help special children. _____
3. Children are more receptive to equine therapy. _____
4. Horse riding has positive effects on the behaviour of disabled children. _____
5. Varsha Rao is among Pushpa's first and most regular students. _____

D. Answer the following questions given :

Writing Skills

1. What does a horse rider wear?
2. How does Equine therapy benefit children?
3. Who is Pushpa Bopaiah? What does she do?
4. How was Shubhajeet Roy benefitted by Equine therapy?
5. Do you think Pushpa is doing a good job? Give reasons for your answer.

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

Simple, Compound and Complex Sentences

Analyse

- ▶ A sentence with just one independent clause is called a **simple sentence**.

Example : Now a fine, cold drizzle was falling.

- ▶ A sentence with two independent clauses joined with a conjunction is called a **compound sentence**. **Coordinating** conjunctions such as **and, but, so, for, either, and, or** usually join compound sentences.

Example : Now a fine, cold drizzle was falling **and** the wind had risen into a steady blow.

Both the clauses can be read as complete sentences.

- ▶ A sentence with one independent clause and one or more dependent clauses joined with a conjunction is called a **complex sentence**. **Subordinating** conjunctions such as **that, which, who, when, unless, though, before, after, as, if, since, because** and **although** join a subordinate clause and a main clause.

Example : When I opened the door, the dog ran away.

In the above sentence, 'When I opened the door,' is not a complete sentence.

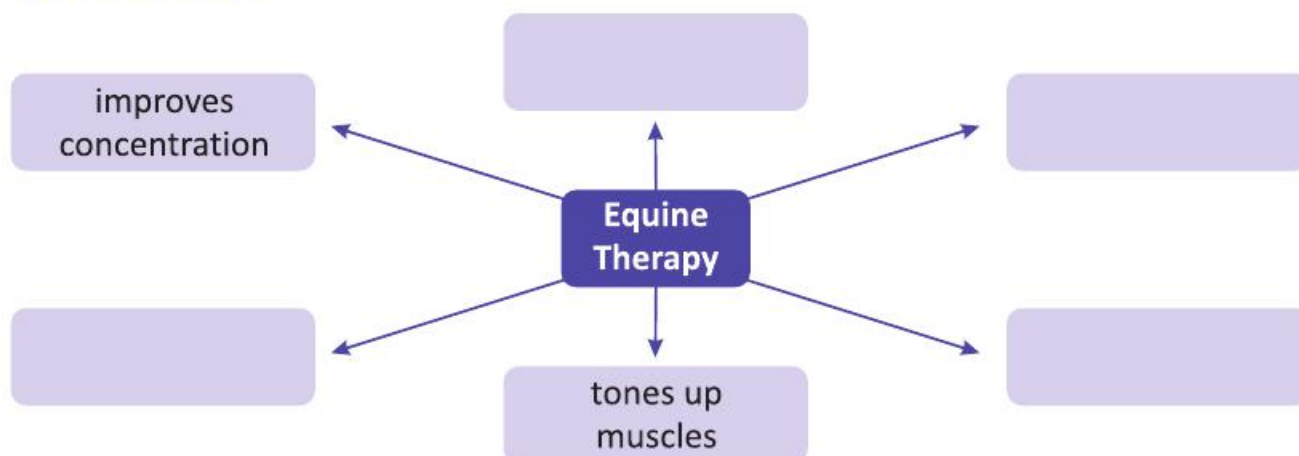
BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. Supply antonyms to the following words :

Experiential Learning

- | | | | |
|--------------|-------|-------------|-------|
| 1. receptive | _____ | 2. disease | _____ |
| 3. healthy | _____ | 4. enroll | _____ |
| 5. lazy | _____ | 6. progress | _____ |
| 7. separate | _____ | 8. serious | _____ |

B. Complete this mind map with some of the examples of the ways that Equine therapy helps special children :



C. Complete these sentences in the way that they make sense :

1. The two friends met after twenty years *and* _____
2. The two friends met after twenty years *but* _____
3. The two friends met after twenty years *or* _____
4. The two friends met after twenty years *yet* _____
5. The two friends met after twenty years *so* _____
6. The two friends met after twenty years *therefore* _____

LET'S WRITE

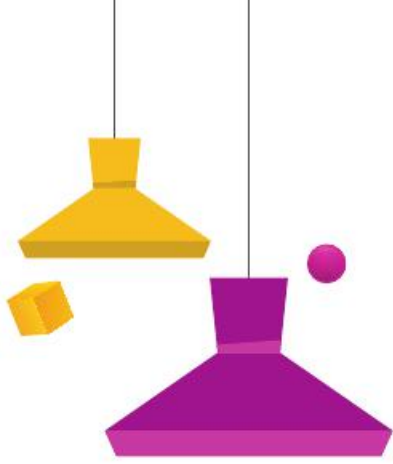
- A survey is a method of gathering information from a group of individuals. The goal is to find out people's stand or opinions on certain matters.
- Do a survey of ten or more students to know their preferences of holidays and write it in the box below.

Writing Skills

Activity Time



- Make a colourful collage to depict an Indian Kaleidoscope. You may choose any one of the following topics :
 - Magnificent historical sites
 - Food and costumes, etc.



3

A Girl with A Basket

I had left New Delhi for the Himalayas. I was going as far as Bareilly by train and then by car to Ranikhet – an old British army hill station located on a 6,000 foot ridge opposite a 120-mile stretch of snow-capped Himalayas. The train was slow; and it stopped at all the way stations. At every stop, I swung open the door of my compartment, and walked the platform.

The platforms were packed with people : Hindus, Muslims, Sikhs; soldiers, merchants, priests, porters, beggars, hawkers. Almost everyone was barefooted and dressed in loose white garments. I would ask at least three people before I could find one who spoke English. We would talk world affairs and every major topic, the news of the day produced. In this way, I was trying to get a feel of the pulse of the nation, checking opinion against official attitudes and reports.



The route lay through one of the richest of India's agricultural areas. This was the plain of the upper Ganga River, a thousand feet above sea level but tropical. The Ganga was brown silt, swollen with flood waters, its overflow inundating thousands of acres of rice. To the north were jungles—great expanses of grass higher than a man's head and unbroken except for an occasional clump of trees—the home of tigers, elephants, pythons and cobras. Everywhere else there was flat land running to the horizon, but dotted here and there by the sacred banyan trees or by rows of pakar trees, shaped like elms and having thick twisted trunks. Hot, humid air was moving in from the south-west. Monkeys—some of them mothers with babies clinging to them and riding underneath—swung off trees at the stations, looking for food. The villages we passed had walls made of mud mixed with water and cow-dung. Their peaked roofs were thatched—bungles of grass tied to bamboo poles, stretched across the rafters. That day the pumpkin vines that grew over them, were in bloom, trailing streaks of yellow over drab walls.

At one station my routine of talking with the people was interrupted. As soon as I alighted, a group of young children gathered around me. They were selling baskets—hand-woven, reed baskets with simple designs and patterns. They held the baskets high, shouting words, I did not know but conveying unmistakably their desire.



These were refugee children. When partition between India and Pakistan was decreed, hundreds of thousands of people pulled up their roots and changed their residences. Nine million people left Pakistan and came to India, driven by the fear of religious fanaticism. They were poor people to start with; they were poorer as they began their long trek; for all they could carry, was a bit of food and a few belongings. Soon they were out of food. A few days after they started, they began to fall by the way-side from the weakness of hunger, and died where they fell.

The children selling baskets were sons and daughters of these refugees. They or their parents or relatives had gathered in the cities, setting up stalls, manufacturing simple articles, trying to make a living in markets, already overcrowded. They lived in cloth and grass sheds that lined the streets. The peasants, among these refugees, had been accustomed to little all their lives for the annual income of an agricultural family does not exceed, on an average, one hundred dollars a year. The average unskilled labourer

makes thirty cents a day or less than two dollars a week. There is one meal a day—an onion, a piece of bread, a bowl of pulse with milk, perhaps a bit of goat cheese. No tea, no coffee, no fat, no sweets, no meat. One hundred dollars a year is not two dollars a week, yet even that small amount is hard to earn by selling baskets to people too poor to buy them. That, no doubt is the reason these little children descended on me like locusts. I, an American, was doubtless, the most promising market, they had seen.

I bought one tiny basket for a few annas, another fruit basket for a bit more, a beautiful waste paper basket for a rupee, a lovely sewing basket for a rupee, a few fans for an anna or two a piece. My arms were filled and I had spent not fifty cents. The children passed in, shouting their wares. I was a prisoner, completely surrounded, unable to move. The most diligent, aggressive vendor was a beautiful girl of nine, right in front of me. She had a lovely basket with handle; and she wanted a rupee and a half for it or about thirty cents. She was an earnest pleader. There were tears in her eyes. She pleaded and begged in tones that would wring any heart.

My arms were full. I had no room, let alone any need, for another basket. Balancing my baskets and fans on my left arm, I reached into my right coat pocket and got a handful change—perhaps fifteen cents in all—which I deposited in the basket that the young girl held imploringly before me. I tried to explain that I could not buy the basket but extended the gratuity as a substitute. I realized at once what offence I had given. This child of nine, dressed in rags and on the edge of starvation, raised her chin, reached into the basket and with all the pride and graciousness of a lady, handed the money back to me. There was only one thing I could do. I bought the basket. She wiped her eyes, smiled and dashed down the platform, headed for some grass hut that would have at least thirty cents that night.

I told this story to Prime Minister Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru. I told him, it was one reason I had fallen in love with India.

The people I saw in India—those in the village as well as those in high office—have both pride and lively sense of decency and citizenship. They also have a passion for independence. This beautiful child—born in squalor and poverty, uneducated in both grammar and manners—had given me a glimpse of the warm soul of India.

New Words to Learn



agriculture area : area that is used for farming; **unmistakably partition** : something that divides the partition.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- The refugee children were selling _____.
 (a) water ☐ (b) cold drinks ☐
 (c) hand-woven baskets ☐ (d) fruits ☐
- The author told the story to _____.
 (a) his father ☐ (b) President of India ☐
 (c) Prime Minister of India ☐ (d) his wife ☐
- The author was travelling from New Delhi to _____.
 (a) Agra ☐ (b) Ranikhet ☐
 (c) Kanpur ☐ (d) Nainital ☐
- The author was travelling by a _____.
 (a) train ☐ (b) train and then a taxi ☐
 (c) taxi ☐ (d) bus ☐
- The beautiful refugee girl was _____.
 (a) nine years old ☐ (b) five years old ☐
 (c) six years old ☐ (d) ten years old ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

- I had left New Delhi for the _____.
- There were _____ children.
- _____ people left Pakistan and came to India.
- An old British army hill station was located on a _____ first ridge.

C. Write T for true and F for false statements :

- The author was much impressed by the Indians. _____
- Ranikhet is an old American army hill station. _____
- The author found that the Indians were very rich. _____
- The author was travelling by a passenger train. _____
- The refugee little girl was insisting the author to buy the basket. _____

D. Answer the following questions :

1. How and why had the author fallen in love with India?
2. Describe the scenes and things the author saw on his way from New Delhi to Ranikhet.
3. What forced the author to buy the little girl's basket?
4. Which vendor among the children drew the author's attention most and why?
5. In what ways were the people on the platform dressed?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

Prepositional Phrases

Analyse

Prepositions can either be used singly, or followed by nouns/pronouns or adjectives to form **prepositional phrases**. Most prepositional phrases consist of a preposition + a noun, pronoun or **-ing** word.

- ▶ **with nouns** : to the borders, at our home, from a man
- ▶ **with pronouns** : for me, of them, of her
- ▶ **with -ing words** : on entering, by leaving

Many time-expressions are prepositional phrases.

Examples : **at** that moment, **at** ten o'clock, **on** the morning of 27 November 2016, **before** midday, **about** 2 o'clock, **during** the week, **by** tomorrow.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. Use each of the following pair of words in your own sentences :

Experiential Learning

1. (a) plain : _____
(b) plane : _____
2. (a) feet : _____
(b) feat : _____
3. (a) lose : _____
(b) loose : _____
4. (a) wine : _____
(b) vine : _____

B. Write the antonyms of the following words :

- | | |
|------------------|-----------------|
| 1. descend _____ | 2. alight _____ |
| 3. major _____ | 4. rare _____ |
| 5. loose _____ | 6. sell _____ |

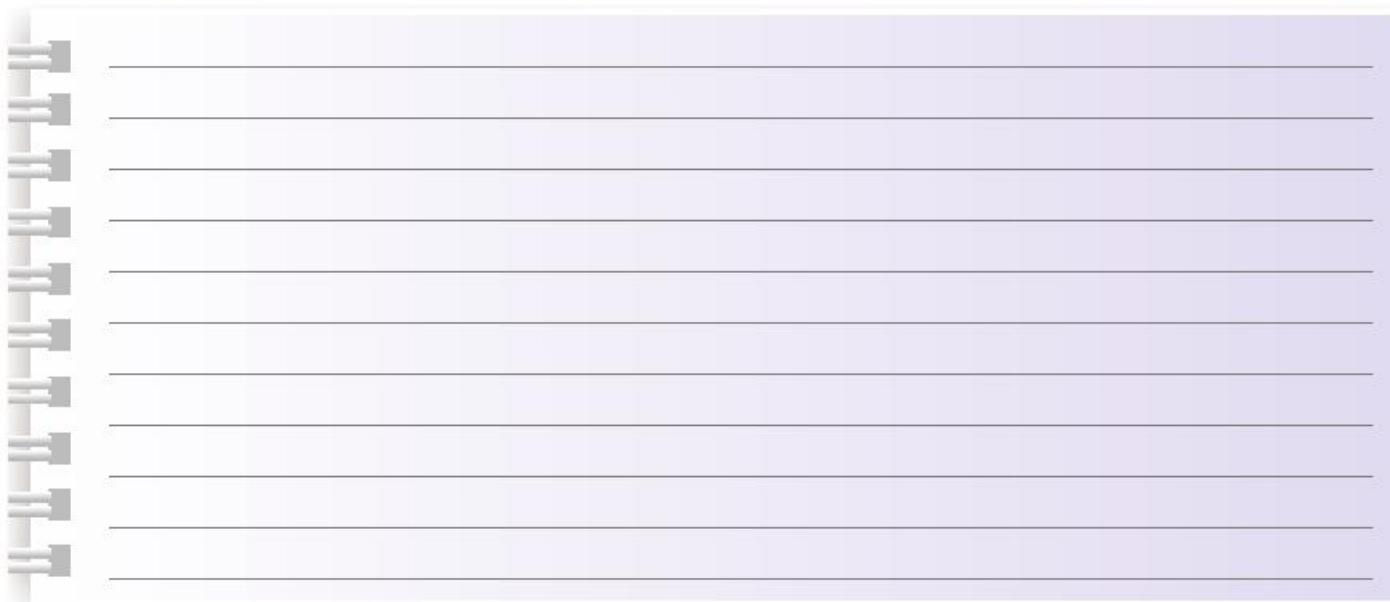
C. Find one word from the lesson for each of the following sentences :

- | | |
|---|---------|
| 1. People employed to carry luggage. | P _____ |
| 2. Long narrow hill top. | R _____ |
| 3. People carrying goods for sale. | H _____ |
| 4. People taking shelter in another place or country. | R _____ |
| 5. Person or thing acting or serving in place of another. | S _____ |

LET'S WRITE

- You want to take part in the All India Quiz Competition. Write a letter to your Principal giving details of the competition and the reasons for participating it. Also give some details of your past experience of such competitions.

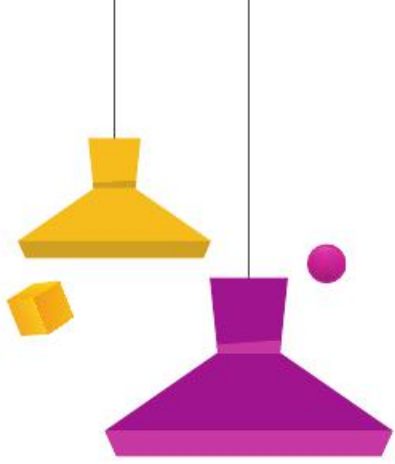
Writing Skills



Activity Time



- Make a collage on occupational activities in different regions of India.



4

Dal Delight

Sadiq was sitting in his father's food shop in the small lane of Lucknow, when he saw a man in a silk **sherwani** got down from a horse at their door. Two helpers followed the man.

'Looks rich'. Is he coming to our shop?' Sadiq wondered. Sadiq's father Mohammad Qadir looked up from the Kebabs he was frying as one of the servants came forward and said grandly, "Nawab Hasan Ali has come!"

The man in silk entered, looked around their small shop and said in bored tones, "I hear you are the famous cook, Mohammad Qadir, I like tasting new dishes. What is your speciality?"

"Dal," said Sadiq's father and went on frying the Kebabs.

"Dal?" The nawab looked surprised. "Only dal?"

"I can make biryani and mutton curry and all the usual things, but you asked me what I cook the best," Qadir replied calmly.

"But, dal! that doesn't sound very exciting. My friends praised your cooking so much, I expected something better."



"But you haven't tasted the dal I make."

"Fine, I'll taste it. What kind of dal you make?"

"Urad."

"Get me some. Let's see what's special about it."



"I haven't got it now."

"What!" The nawab was looking angry now. Sadiq realized worried.

"I only make my **shahi** dal urad on order," Qadir said. "It takes me a day to make it with secret spices. If your honour so wishes, I'll cook it for tomorrow's lunch."

"All right." Nawab Hasan Ali gave in. "I live nearby. You can bring it to my house."

"I'm sorry sir, but that is not possible," said Qadir.

Sadiq sighed. His father lost a lot of customers **by being so difficult**.

Nawab Hasan Ali had never met such a rude cook, yet he was amused, "What's the problem now?"

"Huzoor to enjoy my dal you will have to come to my shop to taste it. It spoils if it is taken off the fire. And your honour, once I call, you will have to come immediately."

"Really? What if I'm late?"

"I'll throw the dal away or feed it to poor," Qadir said as he slid some Kebabs into the hot oil which began to hiss.

Nawab Hasan Ali shook his head. He had never seen a cook like Qadir. Ah well, he thought; let's taste his dal first maybe it will be worth the trouble.

"Call me tomorrow when you are ready," he said and left the shop.

Sadiq, sighed with relief that the nawab had not his temper and gone away. He knew that nawabs often gave handsome rewards to cooks if they liked a dish and his father had nearly spoiled everything. It was lucky the nawab had been in a good mood and agreed to everything Qadir said.

In the evening, Sadiq went with his father to the market to buy the ingredients for the Shahi Dal Urad. Only the best would do, of course.

All of it had to be fresh and perfect Sadiq heard in the market that Nawab Hasan Ali had rewarded many cooks in the past. He hoped nothing would go wrong the next day. You never knew with his father!

Sadiq was at work early next morning helping father—cleaning the dal, making ghee, grinding turmeric, peeling and chopping onions and ginger. Then he watched Qadir cook the dal. The smell was mouth-watering. With the dal Qadir made a light cucumber raita, ming chutney and a dish of cauliflower and potatoes. Once the nawab sat down to eat he would serve freshly baked hot tandoori roti and for dessert there were bowls of phirni. Sadiq had sneaked a quick taste of the dal when his father wasn't looking. It tasted heavenly. It was those secret spices that made all the difference.

The time was right. The dal in the pot bubbled softly on the stove. The dough was ready to be slapped into rotis, the raita cooling in an earthen bowl. Qadir turned to his son and said, "Go call the Nawab, son. I'm ready to serve."

Sadiq ran all the way to the nawab's house. At the door he panted to the servant, "I've come to call the Nawab Saab to lunch." The dal is ready.

"Ah, yes Nawab Saab told me of that. Go up to the roof. He is flying kites there."

Sadiq, puffed up the stairs to the roof. The nawab and his friends were busy with kites and rolls of kite string. Sadiq went up to Hasan Ali and said apologetically, "Sir, the dal is ready. My father is calling you."

Hasan Ali looked down at Sadiq and said, "Who?" and then seemed to remember. "Ah yes, the dal."

One of his friends laughed. "Forget the dal, look! Your kite is in danger, that green one is about to cut it."

Hasan Ali hurriedly pulled his kite away yelling, "Just you wait, green devil! I'll get you!"

"But..." sadly Sadiq gave up. All his dreams were **drifting away**. He knew what would happen, he knew his father's temper. Sadiq could forget about the reward. He fell like crying.

Slowly Sadiq walked home. He looked up to see the nawab's kite flying just overhead. Then he noticed that his friend Aman was flying a kite from his roof top across the lane. Sadiq got an idea. He went up to his friend ...

Soon Sadiq was racing back to the nawab's give a quick pull and...

"Oh no!" Hasan Ali groaned in dismay as his kite swooped and fluttered to the ground.

"Your honour," Sadiq said quickly, "the food is waiting. The dal is delicious."

"Oh yes, yes". The nawab suddenly seemed to remember. "Now the kites gone, let us eat."

The nawab and his friends walked with Sadiq. Nearing the shop Sadiq raced ahead, his heart thumping nervously. "Oh God", he prayed "don't let my father lose his temper, please don't let it be too late."

"They are coming!" he yelled. "Is everything ready?"

"Of course," muttered Qadir. "What too you so long?"

The nawab and his friend entered the shop. A white cloth, was laid out in the best room with the food in the best bowls on it. As they sat down on the carpet, Qadir came in with the dal and Sadiq followed with piping hot rotis and dripping with butter.

Nawab Hasan Ali broke a piece of roti, as Sadiq watched breathlessly, dipped it into the dal, put it in his mouth, chewed slowly and then his eyes closed, "Ah!" he said louder. "Qadir Mian this shahi dal urad **is of the heavens**." I have never tasted such dal before even roast chicken **pales before this**.

You deserve a reward," Hasan Ali continued. What would you like?"

For the first time that day Mohammad Qadir smiled. "I would like to a better food shop, your honour—in a big market. Near the Imambara, may be."

“Done!” said Hasan Ali, dipping into the vegetable. He called one of his servants and waved at Qadir. The servants bowed low and put a bag full of money in Qadir’s hand.

“It should be enough if not ask for more. Now give me some more of your shahi dal and a roti,” said Nawab Hasan Ali.

–Subhadra Sen Gupta

New Words to Learn



sherwani : Long coat; **shahi** : Royal; **by being so difficult** : by being so particular; **drifting away** : chance of dream coming true were decreasing; **is of the heavens** : absolutely delicious; **pales before this** : is nothing compared to this.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Who came to his shop?

(a) Qadir Mohammad

☐

(b) Sadiq

☐

(c) Nawab Hasan Ali

☐

2. How was Mohammed Qadir?

(a) Clever

☐

(b) Hardworking

☐

(c) Greedy

☐

3. At which dish was Qadir best?

(a) Aaloo sabzi

☐

(b) Urad dal

☐

(c) Chicken

☐

4. Who is the writer of the story?

(a) Subash Chandra Goel

☐

(b) Subhadra Sen Gupta

☐

(c) Surender Gupta

☐

5. What reward did Nawab give to Qadir?

(a) Huge amount of money

☐

(b) Better food shop in a big market

☐

(c) None of these

☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. My friends praised your _____ so much.
2. Let's see what a _____ about it.
3. You can bring it my _____.
4. I'm sorry sir but that is not _____.
5. He hoped nothing would go _____ the next day.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. sherwani
2. shahi
3. is of the heavens
4. pales before this
5. by being so difficult

Column 'B'

- a. absolutely delicious
- b. is nothing compared to this
- c. by being so particular
- d. Royal
- e. long coat

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. What condition did Qadir put across Nawab for serving the dal?
2. What reward did the rich man give to Qadir?
3. Who was Sadiq? What was his father's occupation?
4. Who was the rich man came at the shop? Why did he come there?
5. What happened when Sadiq went to call the nawab for lunch?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

A. Say whether the verbs in the following sentences are in the active or passive voice :

1. Arun wrote some fine poems in Malayalam.
2. A long poem was planned by Arun.
3. Arun was inspired by many poets.
4. His mother shared his love of poetry.
5. His first book of poems was published last year.
6. His parents were thrilled by this publication.
7. Arun's poems were loved and read widely.
8. His companions have written to congratulate him.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. Use these words and expressions in sentences of your own :

Critical Thinking

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. presently | 2. partially successful |
| 3. flatter | 4. masculine habitation |
| 5. self-possessed | 6. treacherous |

B. Explain the coloured phrase.

She **broke off** with a little shudder.

C. How would you use the following?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| 1. broke up | 2. broke away |
| 3. broke into | 4. broke in |
| 5. broke down | |

LET'S WRITE

- Write a letter to your friend telling him/her about your experience when you first time sit in a commercial plane :

Writing Skills

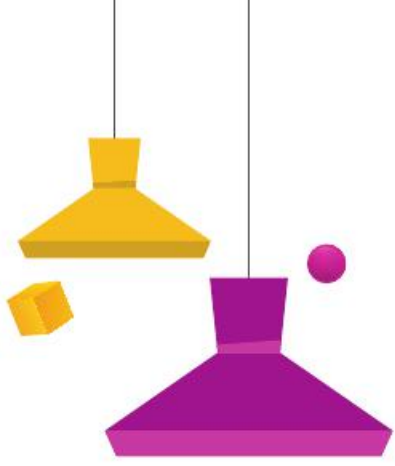
Activity Time



- Put the following name in alphabetical order. Make sure you put the surnames in alphabetical order, before dealing with the initials in each case.

Critical Thinking

- | | |
|------------------|-----------------|
| Thomas, P.E | Anthony, M. |
| Mr. P.Pothen | Thippesway, M. |
| K.I. Thomas | N. Chatterjee |
| K. Singh | Ramachander, A. |
| Ansari, S. | Mohan Singh |
| Choudhuri, Alope | Thomas, P.T. |
| Singh, G.K. | Sridhar, V. |
| Koshy, A. | |



5

The Mahatma's Marksheets

Mahatma Gandhi was one of the most influential men of the 20th century. But what kind of a student had he been? Our curiosity in this regard is understandable and the answers can be found in his own autobiography, *My Experiments with Truth*, and some carefully preserved records of one of the schools in which he studied.

Gandhi had changed many schools before the age of ten, but spent seven years in a high school in Rajkot. He tells us that he was certainly not regarded as a **dunce**. His certificates of progress and character were never bad. He even won prizes at the end of the second standard and scholarships in classes four and five. And yet he says, with **characteristic modesty**, that, that was only due to luck and not merit. In the later years, however, his attendance became **Lax**—a mere 110 days out of 238 in standard III, for example. His marks in the annual examinations normally average between 45 per cent and 55 per cent.



He was even made to repeat a year, partially due to poor attendance because he had to attend to his sick father and his newly wedded wife. He then became a serious student and got an overall score of 66.5%. He could no longer be called a **medicore** student. The Matriculation Exam saw him secure the 404th rank out of 799 successful candidates. His worksheet read :

English : 89/200

Gujarati : 45.5/100

Mathematics : 59/175

General knowledge : 54/150

So much for his academic records. But did he **cope** equally well with all the subjects he had to study? In his own words, 'English became the medium of instruction in most subjects from the fourth standard. I found myself completely **at sea**. Geometry was a new subject in which I was not particularly strong, and the English medium made it still more difficult for me. The teacher taught the subject very well, but I 'would not follow him. Often I would lose heart and think of going back to the third standard. When, however, with much effort I reached the 13th proposition of **Euclid**, the utter simplicity of the subject was suddenly revealed to me. A subject which only required a pure and simple use of one's reasoning powers could not be difficult. Ever since that time geometry there was nothing to memorize, whereas in Sanskrit, I thought everything had to be learnt by heart'.

Did the **frail** but **agile** Gandhi enjoy physical education and sports? In the higher classes, the headmaster of his school had made gymnastics and cricket compulsory for the boys, but he disliked both. He never took part in any exercise cricket or football before they were made compulsory. 'My silliness', he says, 'was one of the reason for this **aloofness**, which I now see was wrong. I then had the false notion that gymnastics had nothing to do with education. Today I know that physical training should have as much place in the curriculum as mental training...' Another regret that Gandhi felt in later years was about the neglect of handwriting. Even until his days in England, he had paid little attention to his handwriting. But later when he was in educated there, he repented of his neglect. To quote him, I saw that bad handwriting should be regarded as a sign of an imperfect education. I tried later to improve mine, but it was too late. I could never repair the neglect of my youth. Let every young man

and woman be warned by my example and understand that good handwriting is a necessary part of education...'

Despite his rather ordinary performance in examinations, Gandhi's middle-school teacher marked his conduct as 'very good'. The records also provide glimpses of some writing that Gandhi did in his English papers. Perhaps an essay that he wrote in about 40 lines on the advantages of a cheerful **disposition** encouraged him to become that rare politician who was never known to have lost his temper! For 25 marks he had been asked to **paraphrase** a poem which described how Jesus would reveal himself only to the poor peasant, not to the rich man whose chariots went 'whirling past'. Might not this exercise have **stroked** an early awareness of **exploitation** and injustice? Such are the records relating to a student who later exerted an influence on countless Indians and turned ordinary teachers, lawyers, clerks and the like into nationalists with heroism and a spirit of self-sacrifice. It has been said that Gandhi could **fashion** heroes out of common clay. His first, and undoubtedly his most successful, experiment was with himself.

—Ramachandra Guha
(Adapted)

New Words to Learn



dunce : slow learner; **characteristic modesty** : expressing a lower opinion; **lax** : careless; **medicore** : not very good; **at sea** : unable to see; **euclid** : a famous Greek Mathematician; **frail** : not strongly made; **agile** : Active; **aloofness** : keeping a distance from people; **disposition** : Natural qualities of person's character; **paraphrase** : To write in different words; **stroked** : Set in motion; **exploitation** : using people unfairly; **fashion** : to shape.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Which language became the medium of instruction in most subjects from the fourth standard?

(a) English

☐ (b) Hindi

☐ (c) Urdu

☐

2. In which subject, he thought everything had to be learnt by heart?
 (a) Hindi ☐ (b) English ☐ (c) Sanskrit ☐
3. What kind of a man was Mahatma Gandhi?
 (a) Encouraging ☐ (b) Influential ☐ (c) Discouraging ☐
4. How many years did Gandhi spend in Rajkot High School?
 (a) Five years ☐ (b) Six years ☐ (c) Seven years ☐
5. What is the name of Gandhiji's autobiography?
 (a) Experiments with Wrong ☐
 (b) Experiments with Truth ☐
 (c) Win from Freedom ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. He tells us that he was _____ not _____ as a dunce.
2. So much for his _____ records.
3. I thought _____ had to be learnt by heart.
4. Might not this _____ have _____ an early awareness of exploitation and injustice.
5. I could never repair the _____ of my youth.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'	Column 'B'
1. dunce	a. to shape
2. lax	b. not very good
3. medicare	c. active
4. agile	d. careless
5. fashion	e. slow barner

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. How was the Mahatma Gandhi as a student?
2. When and what prizes did Gandhi win in school?
3. Write what marks were mentioned in his matriculation worksheet.
4. Did Gandhi enjoy physical education and sports?
5. Which poem was Gandhi asked to paraphrase?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

- In each of the following sentences there is an adjective phrase. These begin with a preposition (of, with, in, etc) underline each phrase : Analyse

- The balloon with the yellow strips burst loudly.
- The dog under the table was growling at the cat on the chair.
- Those hills in the distance form the border between the two countries.
- The driver of the tractor slowed down and stopped.
- We went to visit the man with the large garden.
- She spoke to the woman in the green sari yesterday.
- The love between mother and child is very story.
- The artist's painting of the sea and the hills was sold for a vast sum.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- A. Use the following words in sentences of your own. You may use two or more words in one sentence, if you wish : Critical Thinking

- throw _____
- thrust _____
- push _____
- shift _____
- shove _____
- heaven _____
- move _____
- budge _____
- propel _____
- pitch _____

- B. Find synonyms of the given words:

- | | | | |
|------------|-------|---------------|-------|
| 1. heat | _____ | 2. agreeable | _____ |
| 3. appears | _____ | 4. sleepiness | _____ |
| 5. meadow | _____ | | |

LET'S WRITE

- A. Take one of the qualities of your favourite teacher and say how you think it can be taught to all people, either at home or in school.

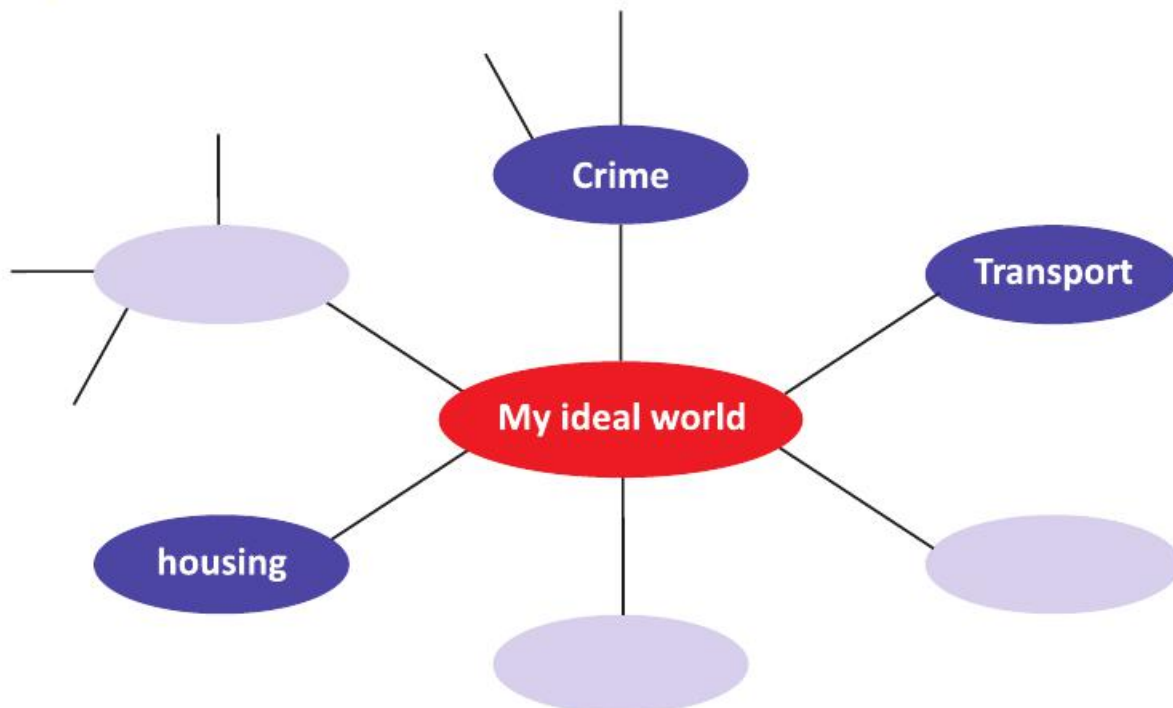
Activity Time

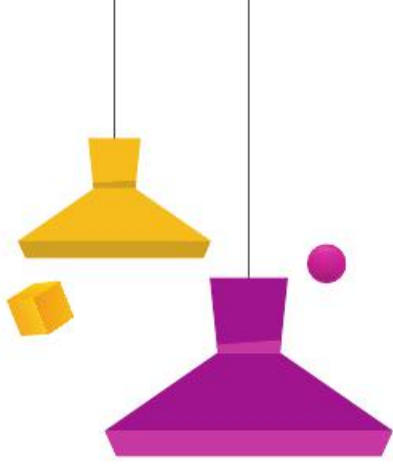


- A. What is your vision of an ideal world?

Creativity

- B. Work in a small group (not more than six). Copy the chart below onto a sheet of paper (You may add more lines and circles if you wish). Keep the main topic the same but add any sub-topics you like.





6

My Elder Brother

My big brother was five years older than me, but only three **grades** ahead. He had begun his studies at the same age as I had, he did not like the idea of proceeding hastily in an important matter like education. He wanted to lay a firm foundation for that **edifice**. So he took two years to do one year's work; sometimes he even took three.

I was the younger, he was the elder, I was nine he was fourteen being older, he had full rights to surprise and instruct me, and I was expected to accept every order of his as law.

By nature he was very **studious** always sitting with a book open before him. On the other hand, I was not at all keen about studying. To pick up a book and sit with it for an hour was a tremendous effort. At first chance, I would have the hostel and go to the play field and play marbles or fly papers butterflies or if I just met a friend—what could be more fun? Sometimes we would climb onto the courtyard walls and jump down, or **straddle** the gate and ride it back and forth, enjoying it as if it were a motor car.

But as soon as I returned to my room and



saw my brother's **scowling** face, I was **petrified**. His first question would be, where are you, I do not know why I could not manage to say that I had just been playing outside. My silence was an **acknowledgment** of my guilt and my brother's only remedy for this was to greet me with a **reproach**, though affectionately.

If you study English this way, you will be studying it the rest of your life and you would not get it right. Studying English is no laughing matter. You have got to wear out your eyes morning and night and use every ounce of energy, then perhaps you will learn the subject you have seen with your eyes how hard I work. Everyday there are cricket and hockey matches, but I do not go near them. I study all the time, even then it takes me two years, or even three to go up one grade. If you want to waste time, it would be better if you just went home and played *gulli-danda* to your hearts content why waste our father's hard-earned money?

With a scolding like, I had started to cry. What could I say in reply?

On another occasion, when I passed and he did not, he said, you have been promoted one grade and your head has been turned by it. Understand this! You did not pass through your own efforts, but stumbled on it by luck. Sometimes in *gulli-danda* too, a lucky shot in the dark hits the goal. But nobody gets to be a good player from it. Don't assume that because I failed I am stupid and you are



smart. When you reach my class, you will **be in a sweat** when you have to bite into Algebra and Geometry, and study English, History 'It is not easy to memorize those kings' names. And as for Geometry, well, God help you! If you write ACB instead of ABC your answer is marked wrong. Nobody asks the hard-hearted examiners what is the difference after all. Does it make any difference if you eat dal, boiled rice and roti, or boiled rice, dal and roti?

'They say : Write an essay on punctuality in not less than four pages.'

Who does not know that punctuality is a very good thing. But do I need four pages for what I can describe in one sentence? We want a man to say what he has to say quickly, but no, you have got to drag it out to four pages. It is **outrageous**! So pay attention to what I say. What if I failed? I am still older than you. I have more experience of the world. Listen to what I say or you will be sorry.

My brother's terrible description of studying in the ninth grade really scared me. I am surprised I did not run away from school and go home. But even a scolding like this did not change my **distaste** for books one bit. I did not miss a single chance to play. I studied much less than before.

Then it was the yearly exams again, and it so happened that once more I passed and my brother failed. I had not done much work, but somehow or other I was in the first division. I myself was astonished. My brother had just about killed himself with hard work, memorizing every word in the course. He had grown pale. But the poor fellow failed again and I felt sorry for him. My pleasure of passing was reduced to half.



There was a difference of only a grade left between my brother and me. The thought crossed my mind that if he failed just once more I had been at the same level as he and then what ground would he have of **lecturing** me? But I violently **rejected** the unworthy idea. Now my brother had become gentler towards me. Perhaps he himself was beginning to understand that he no longer had the right to tell me or at least as much as before. My feeling of independence grew. I began to take advantage of his tolerance. As a result, even the little I used to study earlier because my brother, **ceased**. I found a new pleasure in flying kites. Still I minded my manner with my brother, and concealed my kite flying from him.

One day, far from the hostel, I was running at a **hectic** pace, trying to grab hold of a kite. My eyes were looking skywards at that high flying traveller in the skies that glided smoothly down, like some soul emerging from paradise, freed of wordly

attachment, be incarnated in a new life. A whole army of boys came reaching out to welcome with long, thick bamboo rods. Nobody was aware who was in front or who behind him. It was as though everyone of them was flying along with that kite in the sky, where everything is at one level, without cars or trains or carts.

Suddenly, I collided with my brother. He grabbed my hand and said angrily, 'Aren't you ashamed to be running with these urchins after a stupid kite? You are in the eighth now, and only one behind me. A man has got to have some regard for his position after all. You must have assumed, "I am just one grade behind my brother, so how he does not have the right to say anything to me." But you are mistaken. I am five years older than you and even if you come into my grade today, nobody, not even God, can remove the five years difference between us. The experience I have of life and the world, you can never catch up with, even if you get an MA and D Litt and even a Ph.D.

'Understanding does not come from reading books. Our mother never passed any grades and father probably never went beyond the fifth or the sixth, but they would always have the rights to explain to us and correct us. Not just because they are our parents, but because they will always have more experience of the world.'

I was thoroughly ashamed by this new approach of his. I had truly come to know of my insignificance, and a new respect for my brother was born in my heart. With tears in my eyes, I said, No, no what you say is me and said, I don't forbid you to fly kites. I had like to myself. But what can I do? If I go off the track, how can I watch out for you? That is my responsibility.



Just then by chance a kite that had been cut loose passed over us with its string dangling down. A crowd of boys were chasing it. My brother is very tall, and leaping up, he caught hold of the string and ran widely towards the hostel. I can close behind.

—Munshi Premchand

New Words to Learn



grade : (here) one of the levels in a school with children of similar age; **edifice** : (here) Education **studious** : spending a lot of time studying or reading; **straddle** : sit with one of your legs on either; **scolding** : angry or annoyed; **petrified** : extremely frightened; **acknowledgment** : an act of accepting that something is true; **reproach** : criticism; **be in a sweat** : frightened about something; **outrageous** : shocking; **distaste** : unpleasant; **lecturing** : criticizing somebody; **rejected** : refused to accept; **ceased** : stopped; **hectic** : fast; **incarnated** : born again as someone else; **collided** : crashed into each other.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. How old was the elder brother?

(a) Nine

(b) Fourteen

(c) Fifteen

2. How was the elder brother's nature?

(a) Careless

(b) Studious

(c) Funny

3. How old was the younger brother?

(a) Nine

(b) Fourteen

(c) Fifteen

4. What did younger brother use to do when his elder scolded him?

(a) Stand quietly and listen

(b) Fight with him

(c) Beats him

5. Who is the author of the story 'My Elder Brother'?

(a) Munshi Chand

(b) Munshi Premchand

(c) Munshi Kabir

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. He wanted to lay a firm _____ for that edifice.

2. On the other hand, I was not at all keen about _____.

3. Studying English is no _____ matter.
4. Everyday there are _____ and hockey matches.
5. But nobody gets to be a good _____ from it.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'	Column 'B'
1. reproach	a. fast
2. outrageous	b. stopped
3. distaste	c. unpleasant
4. ceased	d. shocking
5. hectic	e. criticism

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. How was the elder brother in the studies?
2. How was the younger brother in the studies?
3. What was the reason that the elder brother was only three grades ahead in school from younger brother even though he was five year older?
4. Why did the younger brother say that my pleasure of passing was reduced to half?
5. What is the moral of the story?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

A. Can you explain the meaning of each sentence in A and B :

Analyse

A

- i. How many would he kill, I wonder?
- ii. How many should he kill, I wonder?
- iii. How many ought he to kill, I wonder?
- iv. How many must he kill, I wonder?
- v. How many might he kill, I wonder?

B

1. Meat- ants could bite.
2. Meat- ants should bite.
3. Meat- ants ought to bite.
4. Meat- ants must bite.
5. Meat- ants might bite.

B. Now look at the following sentences:

"I ought to save him, Morvenna thought.

'I oughtn't to let....

Ought is usually followed by a to-infinitive.

Examples: ought to go, ought to eat, ought to see.

In the negative, ought is followed by not and can be shortened to **oughtn't to**.

Example: I oughtn't to let him kill any more. In a question, we put the word **ought** in front of the subject.

Example: **Ought** she to let the meat-ant escape?

Ought to expresses three things:

(i) Duty or moral obligation.

Example: We **ought** to help those people who are old and sick.

The ministers felt they **ought** to go to their colleagues's funeral.

(ii) Probability or supposition.

Example: He left Delhi yesterday, so he **ought** to be here tomorrow.

(iii) Admirability or desirability

Examples: You **ought** to buy new tyres for your car; you may have an accident.

There **ought** to be more goods available this shop, it is supposed to be supermarket.

Make up interesting sentences of your own using the following :

1. ought to feel _____
2. ought to go _____
3. ought to write _____
4. ought to have been _____
5. oughtn't to hear _____
6. ought he to _____
7. ought to know _____
8. oughtn't to play _____
9. ought they to return _____

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- The letters are jumbled. Unscramble the letters and insert them in the appropriate blank spaces in the sentences given. (Consult the words to know list for help). **Problem Solving**

DRY FEZ LINE

MONSOON OUT

DEMON IS SUN

RESTUXEDO

SPOC IS MAD

LENS IS PRETTY

- Velu is _____ late for school; he seems to come on purpose.
- It was clear that the animal was going to die, its breathing was _____ and its pupils were dilated.
- The trapped mongoose _____ tried to grow through the rope to get free.
- With a _____ flick of his wrist the batsman turned the ball to the leg side for four runs.
- The scenery in the desert was dull and _____; the children were thoroughly bored by the time they reached the oasis.
- The plot was not large, but its _____ were sufficient for a tennis court to be built on it.

LET'S WRITE

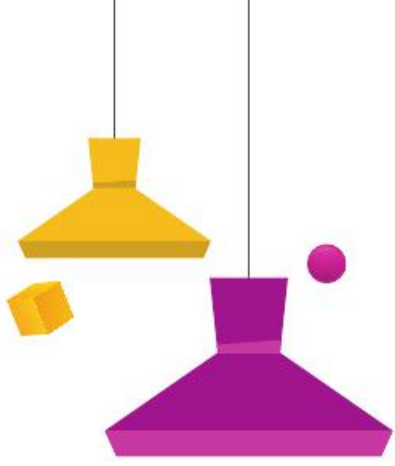
- Describe a hobby or pastime that you enjoy by yourself and explain why it is pleasant to be alone : **Writing Skills**

Activity Time



- Your class has decided to conduct a survey of students's opinion regarding the school curriculum. Work in a group and make questionnaire such as: **Critical Thinking**

- What do you like most about the curriculum?
- What do you dislike the most?
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____



7

The Hour of Heroism

The **tsunami**, which left 2,50,000 dead or missing in Asia, was almost unimaginably destructive. After the waters receded, Banda Aceh, Indonesia, the most devastated city, resembled Hiroshima after the atomic bomb, only a few building survived. Corpses were piled on the streets and in



pick up trucks. Yet amid the grief and loss and mortal dangers, ordinary individuals like Erurn and Jack proved themselves capable of extraordinary courage and selflessness—the very essence of heroism. A common human reaction to **trauma** of a natural disaster is **paralysis**. But extraordinary events also evoke uncommon bravery. Erwin, a 37 year old flower seller in Banda Aceh, was driving to his home by motor bike when the December 26, 2004 tsunami hit. He found safety with hundreds of others on a hump backed bridge arched above the swollen Aceh River. The black water looked like heavy mud, he recalls. It was filled with corpses, cars, dead animals. There was so much rubble you could hardly see the water. Suddenly the crowd on the bridge heard cry : ‘Papa! Papa!’ Erurn scanned the river, but couldn’t locate the

source of the appeal. A man standing next to him pointed. There's a little girl over there.

A child of about three was clinging to a wooden plank in the middle of the river. 'There were so many men on the bridge,' Erwin says, 'but nobody made a move.' A policeman with a video camera contented himself was filming the girl as she drifted by. "I realised then that nobody was going to help, so I ran to the riverside and waded into the water. It was filled with **debris**," and my feet kept getting stuck in fishing nets. After struggling for nearly fifteen minutes, he reached the girl. I yelled to the men on the bridge to get the girl from me because I was getting tired, but again, no one moved. I guess they were very scared. I thought I had lost hold of her. Then I saw a youngman going into the water **paddling** towards me. I will never forget that moment in my life. I will never forget his face.

The face belonged to Heru (Jack) Kurniawan, a 27 years old works at a amusement park. 'It was obvious that someone had to do something,' says Jack 'or both of them would drown.' Jack waded to the middle of the river—trying to avoid the dead bodies—and when he attempted to lift the girl on his shoulder, she screamed in pain her right foot was caught in a fishing net. Erwin struggled to untangle her while Jack concentrated on staying a float. 'I kept telling myself to hang on,' Jack recalls, 'or all of us would drown.'

When the two men got the weeping child to the riverbank, they parted without introducing themselves. For eight months Jack believed Erwin was the little girl's father. He was mistaken. The two men were chance bystanders risking their lives to save a total stranger.

Sadly, tsunami stories from Aceh, even accounts of exceptional personal courage, rarely have completely happy endings. Some months later Erwin and Jack met once again and instantly recognised each other. As they recalled the event of that day, Erwin began to speak of how his own family had been affected. Although his wife and two eldest children survived, his youngest child, a five years boy died in the tsunami. He does not know the fate of the young girl whom he and Jack saved.

'It would make a big difference to me to know that she survived, Erwin says, 'Then I could accept the fact that although I lost my own son. I helped save the life of someone else's child.'



tsunami : extremely large wave in the sea caused by an earthquake; **trauma** : Sadness; **paralysis** : Totally inability to move, act, function etc.; **debris** : Pieces from something that has been destroyed; **paddling** : Walking in water that is not very deep



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Was Erurn the daughter of Jack?

(a) Yes

(b) No

(c) Don't know

2. How many people were died in tsunami?

(a) 2,500

(b) 25,000

(c) 2,50,000

3. What was the reaction of humans for the natural disaster?

(a) Good

(b) Angry

(c) Paralysis

4. How old was Erwin?

(a) 35

(b) 36

(c) 37

5. When did tsunami stuck on?

(a) 24 December, 2004

(b) 26 December, 2004

(c) 25 December, 2004

B. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. tsunami

2. trauma

3. paralysis

4. paddling

5. debris

Column 'B'

a. destroyed

b. walking in water that is not very deep.

c. totally inability to move, act, function

d. sadness

e. underseavolcanic eruption

C. Fill in the blanks :

1. But _____ events also evoke uncommon bravery.

2. The black water looked live _____, he recalls.
3. I will never forget that _____ in my life.
4. I guess they were very _____.
5. I helped save the life of _____ else's child.

D. Answer the following questions:

1. What do you mean by the word 'True Heroism'?
2. How did Erwin and Jack save the life of the little girl?
3. What happened at the end of the incident?
4. What is Tsunami?
5. How did people react to this natural disaster?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

A. Punctuate the following to make it sensible :

Experiential Learning

I saw a peacock with a fiery tail
 I saw a blazing comet drop down hail
 I saw a cloud with ivy circled around
 I saw a sturdy oak creep on the ground
 I saw an ant swallow up a whale
 I saw a raging sea brimful of ale
 I saw a Venice glass sixteen foot drop
 I saw a well full of men's tears that weep
 I saw their eyes all in a flame of fire
 I saw a house as big as the moon and higher
 I saw the sun even in the midst of night
 I saw the man that saw their wondrous sight

Insert apostrophes where necessary.

1. We spoke to his father who is in his nineties.
2. In the forties India gained her Independence.
3. In 92 Kapil scored five 50s.
4. The MLAs who attended the meeting in 86 stayed in five DIGs houses.
5. All the PMs speeches at the conference were recorded and filmed.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. Correct the mistakes in the following, if any :

Problem Solving

- | | |
|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. lfowre | 2. leafs |
| 3. india | 4. dezire |
| 5. efam | 6. strawberries |
| 7. axept | 8. springg |
| 9. newspaper | 10. openning |
| 11. god | 12. thieves |
| 13. innoscent | 14. solitary |
| 15. spase | |

B. Use your dictionary to change the following nouns to adjectives remember that there are a number of ways in which this is done. Here are some suffixes which may help:

___ful, ___y, ___ish, ___ous

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| 1. pain | 2. scandal |
| 3. clay | 4. child |
| 5. space | 6. fame |
| 7. boy | 8. meaning |
| 9. sleep | 10. law |
| 11. desire | 12. spring |

LET'S WRITE

- Every year in January, on the eve of Republic Day, awards are given to children who performed feats of bravery Hanboklang Nongrief was the recipient of the Bapu Gayandani Award. Let us suppose you were one of ten students of your school who had the pleasure of meeting him and talking to him.

Write a report for your school magazine describing your meeting with him, your impression of him and the heroic deed that earned him this award :

Writing Skills

Activity Time

- With your partner do survey and write about any five profession who do work for the welfare of the people.

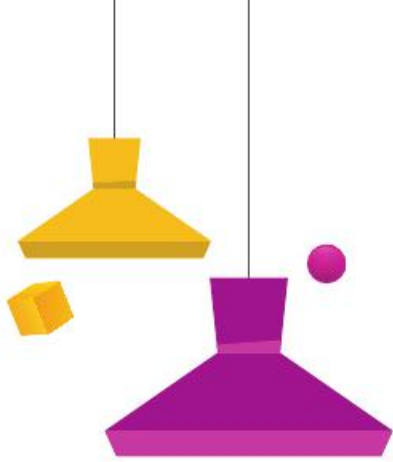
1.

2.

3.

4.

5.



8

Queen of the Skies

Interviewer : Why did you want to be a pilot when there were no women pilots.

Durba : In my time, girls were just becoming teachers and doctors. I thought I should be completely different. And I had read a poem as a child about walking the skies, and that had fired my imagination about flying. My father was a **liberal**, educated man and always supported me. He encouraged me by saying, “The women in my family have taught me that girls can do better than men in whatever they undertake.”

Interviewer : When did you start flying?

Durba : I first, started flying in 1951. I became a pilot with great difficulty. No one was willing to hire me because I was a woman. They were scared to be piloted by a woman! Whenever I went for flying tests in Kolkata, they kept issuing medical certificates saying my eyesight was not OK. Finally, my instructor suggested that I try my luck in Delhi. I went there, got a licence and started flying in 1953.

I approached Air Marshall Mukherjee and **pestered** him with endless requests that I be allowed to enter the Air Force till he wrote to the Director of Air survey to hire me as a survey pilot. I was paid only ₹ 3000 while male pilots earned ₹ 22,000. I was asked to carry out flights for **aerial** mapping. I had to fly at a height of 15,000 feet without oxygen and pressurization. It was quite risky. It was also very tedious as the photographer made me flyover and over the

same area again and again until he got the co-ordinates right. It was very complicated work.

Interviewer : Was flying rewarding in those days?

Durba : My salary was only ₹ 356 when I first joined as a pilot. The first plane I ever flew was a Tiger Moth. It was very small with the wings on the top and the bottom. It was made of cloth and open on top. My helmet and belt were the only safety. I kept trying for a commercial airlines job but they never even bothered to reply to my applications. When I sent on application without prefixing Miss in front of my name, they called me for the interview but when they saw that I was a girl, they immediately rejected me.

Interviewer : When did you begin flying as a commercial pilot?



Durba : In 1957, I joined Airways India as a commercial pilot. I flew **freight** and passengers from Ambari to Kolkata and back Indian Airlines refused to accept me initially. They preferred to hire men with 100 hours flying experience even though I had already **logged** 6000 hours! It was only in 1996 that I finally joined IA.

Interviewer : Was it difficult being the only woman pilot?

Durba : The male pilots accepted me almost immediately. In the air I was just another pilot and they judged me on my performance. I never

saw myself as an extraordinary phenomenon. I just wanted to do the job as best as I could as it was my bread and butter. I never felt one up on my colleagues.

IA also treated me fairly once. I joined them. Initially, it was some passengers who were afraid to fly with me. Many VIPs used to mistake me for an air hostess. I need to enjoy the shock on their faces when they learnt the truth!

Interviewer : What routes were you flying and what were the planes you flew?

Durba : I flew all the eastern routes, as well as to Chandigarh, Kashmir, Leh, Chennai, Colombo, Male, Andamans and of course to Bangladesh. I flew a Fokker friendship, a Chipmunk, a Dakota, an Avion as well as a Boeing and an Airbus 300. I am mentioned in the Guinness Books of World Records as the first woman pilot to fly an A300.

Interviewer : When did you earn your commander's badge?

Durba : For getting any command I had to go through so many tests that I almost gave up in **despair**. It was only in 1977 that I became a commander, and as captain Durba Banerjee, I went to the US as the Indian representative at the World Lady Pilot's Association gathering.

Interviewer : Which are some of your most memorable flights?

Durba : My first solo flight, when my sister and I flew alone to Delhi to attend the International fair and my heart was bursting with joy. I felt I had finally achieved my dream. I also remember flying DC3's in Arunachal Pradesh to drop food packets. I applied to the government for flying food and **ammunition** to soldiers during the Sino-Indian /Indo-China war. I remember the **anguish** of the soldiers who were starving. I didn't even have on my uniform—I just wore a *salwar kameez*, and when we landed for full in a small town, people were surprised to see me that they thought we might be spies! Another time I remember racing against the clock as we were flying with a marriage party on board. We landed at an air force base in the nick of time before the auspicious hour for the wedding passed.

Interviewer : Any disasters or scary moments?

Durba : I remember landing without communication aids in the paddy fields in dense fog in Coochbehar. The villagers thought we had landed from heaven! One of my most terrifying memories was when I was caught in a storm. We were flying over the Ganga and the weather was fierce. From 16,000 feet the storm threw us down to 12,000 feet and then to 4,000 feet. I thought we would hit the ground. All the engine **guages** had started freezing by then and the engines were croaking as if they would fail. We just kept our courage and used all the strength in us to climb up again. God saved us. When we returned to Kolkata, the engineers told us that the wings on both sides had only one joint left after this drama, and may have fallen off any time!

Interviewer : Any regrets.

Durba : I never married as I thought my career would not allow me to devote sufficient time to family life. I never took a days leave in my life, even for sickness. But overall, it has been great.

Interviewer : What advice would you give aspiring women pilots?

Durba : Many girls think that a pilot's life is glamorous, but they have to be willing to sacrifice a lot. It is a hard life with no fixed hours. You have to be ready to fly anytime, night or day I would advise women to join the Air Traffic Control on the meteorological department if they cannot become pilots straight away and not to give up hope.

Interviewer : Do you miss flying now?

Durba : I stopped flying in 1989 when I retired from IA. By then I had logged 19,500 flight hours. I had no means to fly privately after I retired. But I still fly as a passenger. I love travelling and I get two free passes every year to travel anywhere in the world.

**–Interviewed by
Moutussi Acharyya**

New Words to Learn



liberal : not very closed in outlook but willing to; **pestered** : keep asking; **aerial** : attacked by people in aeroplanes; **freight** : Goods carried; **logged** : Recorded officially; **pestered** : Keep asking; **despair** : lose hope; **ammunition** : explosives, bombs, bullets; **guages** : instruments used for measurement.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. When did she stop flying?

(a) 1987

(b) 1988

(c) 1989

2. When did Durba Banerjee start flying?

(a) 1950

(b) 1951

(c) 1952

3. Which plane was flown by Durba Banerjee?

(a) A Boing

(b) An A 300

(c) A Dakota

4. Which one was of the first plane flown by Durba Banerjee?

(a) Silk Moth

(b) Tiger Moth

(c) Bird Moth

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. My father was a _____, educated man and always supported me.

2. I first, _____ flying in 1951.

3. I went there, got a _____ and stated flying in 1953.

4. I was asked to carry out _____ for aerial mapping.

5. In _____, I joined Airways India was a commercial pilot.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. despair
2. anguish
3. pestered
4. freight
5. logged

Column 'B'

- a. goods carried
- b. lose hope
- c. great pain
- d. recorded officially
- e. lose hope

D. Answer the following questions:

1. Who interviewed her?

2. Who is Durba Banerjee?

3. Was flying rewarding in those days?

Writing Skills

4. When did Durba begin flying as a commercial pilot?
5. Was it difficult being the only woman pilot?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

- **By changing the order of words in the following sentences, or by using it, make them more exciting and emphatic :**

Analyse

1. The children let out a shriek of delight when the bell rang.
2. The bomb exploded without warning and the bridge collapsed.
3. That meat of roast duck was the best they ever had.
4. The monster emerged silently from the dark cave.
5. A huge grey elephant loomed out of the fog just in front of the jeep.
6. There was a loud scream suddenly from the house next door when I was sitting alone reading.
7. The day Gandhi was shot dead was a sad day for all of us.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- **What is the meaning of 'ye'?**

Problem Solving

Here are some words, which you may come across in old English poetry. Look up the meanings in a dictionary. Then write out the words (and the meanings) in alphabetical order in your book.

Ye you yonder thy thine
thou yea quoth he prithee art (see be)
may high doth

- **Idiomatic language**

'To go west' means to 'to, be lost
or destroyed or 'to die'.

- **Find out what these expressions mean, and use them in sentences of your own:**

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. go to town | 2. go under the knife |
| 3. go to waste | 4. go up in flames |
| 5. go to great pains | 6. go up in smoke |
| 7. go with a bang | 8. go without |
| 9. go long with | 10. go begging |

LET'S WRITE

- Write an essay in about 200 words on the topic, "Importance of Internet in our daily life."

Writing Skills

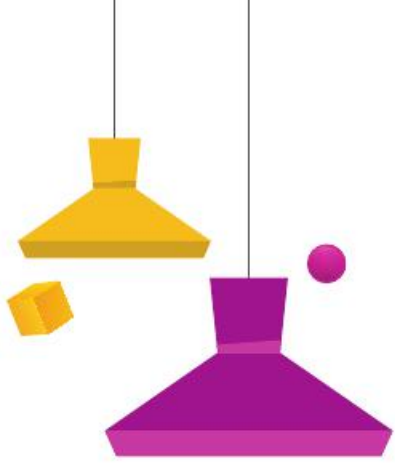
Activity Time



- Say the following loudly and clearly :

Communications

1. Fuzzy Wuzzy was a bear,
Fuzzy Wuzzy had no hair.
Fuzzy Wuzzy wasn't fuzzy,
Was he?
2. A big black bug bit a big black bear,
Made the big black bear bleed blood.
3. Pope Sixtus VI's six texts.
4. A tutor who tooted a flute
Tried to tutor two tooters to toot.
Said the two to their tutor,
'Is it harder to toot
Or to tutor two tooters to toot?



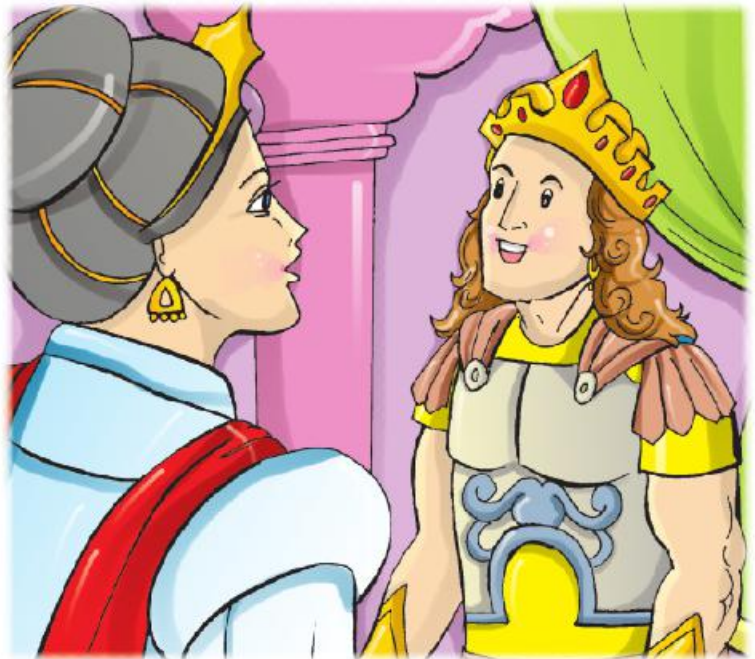
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A Poor Princess

Once there was a queen and king. The queen's name was Queen Samantha and the King's name was King Harry. They were a sad couple because a few months after the king and queen got married they had a child. Here, it was little different story. The queen and king had been married for 10 years and they still had no children.

One day, as Queen Samantha sat sewing beside the window sill, she saw a shooting star in broad daylight.

"Oh, my," she thought. "It must be a magical star. I'll make a wish." She did just that. And you know what she wished for? She wished for a child. A few days later she gave birth to a baby girl. The kingdom was filled with happiness. King Harry held a festival in honour of the princess. One of the



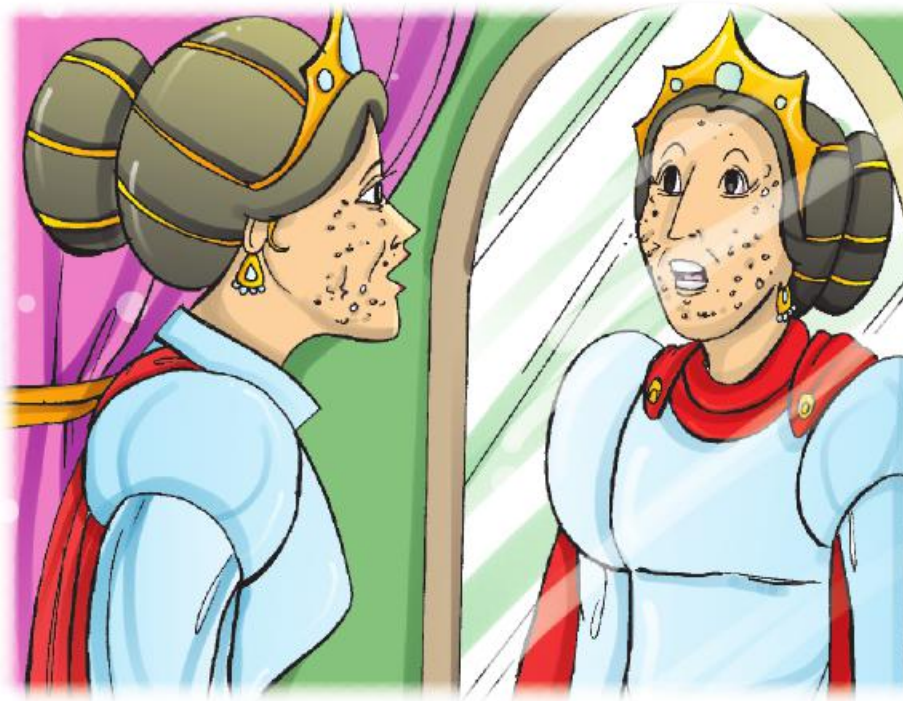
things in the festival was to give a name to the child. After the festival was over, Queen Samantha and king Harry would select a name. By the end of the festival, there was quilt a long list. It took quite a while but finally Queen Samantha and King Harry decided on Dorothy. It was a beautiful name.

When Dorothy turned young then, she was for the first time, permitted to go into the woods all by herself. Now in this very woods, there lived a witch, and a very mean

witch at that. Back to our story now. Dorothy was so happy that she danced. She danced by the crashing creek. She danced into the clearing where the **cranky** old witch lived. It so happened that she danced into the witch's flower bed and happened to step on a **potion** flower. To make it worse, the witch was watching the whole thing.

"Alacazam! Alackazoo! A very terrible fate shall fall upon you!" **screeched** the witch. At the sound of the witch's voice, Dorothy spun around, screamed and ran. She ran out of the flower bed. She ran out of the clearing. She ran by the crashing creek. By the time she got home, she was totally out of breath and her dress was torn.

"What's happened to you?" asked Queen Samantha.



"Oh, mother. I'm really sorry. You see, I was running through the woods, and my dress caught on a **bramble**," said Dorothy.

"No, not that, child. Don't you ever look in a mirror?" said Queen Samantha. Following her mother's orders, Dorothy went over to the mirror and looked in.

"Oh, my!" she cried. "It must be the witch's spell! To be

ugly!" The princess had been very beautiful up until now. But now she had short hair and **buck** teeth.

"Harry," called Queen Samantha.

"Yes," said King Harry.

"I'd like you to go into the woods to find the witch," she said.

"I'm on it!" answered King Harry. So he rounded up three nights to go with him into the forest. After a while, they rode past the crashing creek. They rode into the clearing where the witch lived. They rode up to her yard and halted their horses. King Harry dismounted and walked up to the witch's hut. He knocked on the hut door.

"What do you want?" said the witch.

"I'm here to see that you undo the spell you put on my daughter," answered King Harry.

"Can't undo it, but she can, by finding someone who loves her. Good bye!" said the witch, closing the door. King Harry remounted his horse, then turned around and started home. When they got home, King Harry spilled the news to his family.

"And she's not even old enough to marry," said the queen, disgusted, once she's heard. Dorothy just cried.

Eight sad years passed. Soon Dorothy would be turning eighteen. On the day of her eighteenth birthday, Dorothy was walking in the forest (being very careful not to go into the clearing where the witch lived). As she was walked along, she came across an ugly prince.

"Oh, I'm very sorry," said Dorothy.

"That's Okay," said the prince. "What's your name? My name is Henry."

"My name is Dorothy," said Dorothy.

"You know, you're beautiful," said Henry.

"Well, you're handsome," said Dorothy.

"Will you marry me?" asked Henry.

"Sure, if my parents say, yes," answered Dorothy.

"Come on, let's go to my **castle**."

When they came to the king's and queen's chambers, Dorothy said, "May I marry this prince?"

"Sure," was both parents responses.

On the wedding day, when Henry and Dorothy both said, "I do, there was suddenly a **gust** of wind. When it had gone, in the place of an ugly princess there was a beautiful princess. In the place of an ugly prince, there was a handsome prince.

Dorothy and Henry lived happily ever after.

New Words to Learn



sill : shelf along the bottom edge of a window; **cranky** : strange; **potion** : drink that have magic power; **screeched** : makes noise; **bramble** : wild prickly bushes; **buck** : male of animals like deer, rabbit etc.; **castle** : is a large building with thick, high walls; **gust** : strong sudden rush of wind.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- What was the name of their daughter?
 (a) Drownly ☐ (b) Dorothy ☐ (c) Cinderalla ☐
- What was the terrible fate given by the witch?
 (a) Alacazam ☐
 (b) Alackazoo ☐
 (c) Alacazam! Alackazoo! ☐
- What was the name of the queen?
 (a) Queen Samaria ☐ (b) Queen Samantha ☐ (c) Queen Pearl ☐
- What was the name of the Prince whom she met in the forest?
 (a) Harry ☐ (b) Henry ☐ (c) Hari ☐
- At what age Dorothy could marry?
 (a) Sixteen ☐ (b) Seventeen ☐ (c) Eighteen ☐

B. Fill in the blanks:

- She saw a _____ star in broad daylight.
- A few days later she gave _____ to a baby girl.
- _____ was so happy that she danced.
- A very _____ fate shall fall upon you.
- The princess had been very _____ up until now.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B':

Column 'A'

- cranky
- screeched
- bramble
- castle
- buck

Column 'B'

- male of animals
- wild prickly pushes
- high walls
- makes voice
- strange

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. How did the ugly Princess turn back into beautiful Princess?
2. What happened on the wedding day?
3. Why were King and Queen sad?
4. How did Dorothy take birth?
5. What happened when one day the ten-year old Dorothy went to the forest?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

- Read the following sentences. Some of the sentences have commas missing. In some sentences a comma is optional in others they are necessary. Can you tell, by reading them aloud where the commas should be inserted? Then listen to the sentences. Did you place the commas correctly?

Analyse

1. The Headmaster told the teachers what time the assembly would be held.
2. The head boy told the others whether they liked it or not to stand in line.
3. The stranger who entered the room stared at me for a few minutes.
4. The Taj Mahal that is the centre of attraction in Agra stands on the southern bank of the river Yamuna.
5. Arun said he would come to the party even though he had work to do that day.
6. The tailor said he would mend the trousers as they were torn.
7. The Major known to his soldiers as 'King Kong' was a large man with a ferocious moustache.
8. Where the three of us now stood in a bunch we had the smooth steep rock behind us to our right as wall of rock slightly leaning over the ravine and fifteen feet high and to our left a tumbled bank of big rocks thirty or forty feet high.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- Use these expressions in sentences of your own. Try to bring out the meaning of the words in a lively way :

Critical Thinking

1. waste my soul
2. with all my might
3. strained apart
4. slovenly work
5. the same abyss

LET'S WRITE

- Work with a partner. Think of at least three responses for each of the following statements with 'should', 'ought' and 'must'. Write them down : Writing Skills

1. She is restless.
2. They are climbing trees.
3. The dog was barking all night.
4. She has a train to catch in ten minutes.
5. They are always late with their homework.
6. They have an appointment to see the Headmaster tomorrow.
7. He has taken my wallet.
8. They are lost.

Activity Time



- Search from Internet or take the help of your teacher and write 8 lines on William Shakespeare : Writing Skills

1.

2.

3.

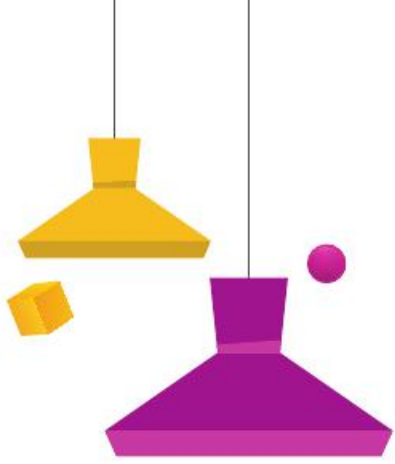
4.

5.

6.

7.

8.



10 Karma

Sir Mohan Lal looked at himself in the mirror of first class waiting room at the railway station. The mirror was obviously made in India. The red oxide at its back had come off at several places and long lines of translucent glass cut across its surface. Sir Mohan smiled at the mirror with an air of pity and patronage.

“You are so very much like everything else in this country, inefficient, dirty, indifferent,” he murmured. The mirror smiled back at Sir Mohan.

“You are a bit of all right old chap,” it said. Distinguished, efficient—even handsome. That neatly trimmed moustache—the suit from Saville Row with the carnation in the buttonhole—the aroma of **eau de cologne**, talcum powder, and scented soap all about you! Yes, old fellow, you are a bit of all right.”



Sir Mohan threw out his chest smoothed his tie, waved a goodbye to the mirror. He glanced at his watch. There was still time for a quick one.

‘Koi hai?’

A bearer in white livery appeared through a wire gauze door.

‘**Ek Chota**’ ordered Sir Mohan and sank into a large cane chair to drink and **ruminate**.

Outside the waiting room Sir Mohan Lal's luggage lay piled along the wall. On a small grey steel trunk Lachmi, lady Mohan Lal, sat drawing a betel leaf and fanning herself with a newspaper. She was short and fat and in her middle forties. She wore a dirty white *sari* with a red border. On one side of her nose glistened a diamond nose-ring, and she had several gold bangles on her arms. She had been talking to the bearer until Sir Mohan had summoned him inside. An soon as he had gone, she hailed a passing railway coolie.

'Where does the **zenana** stop?'

'Right at the end of the platform.'

The coolie flattened his turban to make a cushion, hoisted the steel trunk on his head and moved down the platform. Lady Mohan Lal picked up her brass tiffin-carrier and ambled along behind him. On the way she stopped by a **hawker's** stall to replenish her silver betel-leaf case, and then joined the coolie. She sat down on her steel trunk (which the coolie had put down) and started talking to him.

'Are the trains very crowded on these lines?'

'These days all trains are crowded, but you'll find room in the zenana.'

'Then I might as well get over the bother of eating.'

Lady Lal opened the brass carrier and took out a bundle of cramped *chapattis* and some mango pickle. While she ate, the coolie sat opposite her on his haunches, drawing lines in the gravel with his finger.

'Are you travelling alone, sister?'

'No, I am with my master, brother. He is in the waiting room. He travels first class. He is vizier and a barrister, and meets so many officers and Englishmen in the trains—and I am only a native woman. I can't understand English and don't know their ways, so I keep to my zenana inter-class.'

Lachmi chatted away merrily. She was fond of little gossip and had no one to talk to at home. Her husband never had any time to spare for her. She lived in the upper storey of the house and he on the ground floor. He did not like her poor illiterate relatives hanging about his bungalow, so they never came. He just ordered her about in anglicised Hindustani, and she obeyed passively. These nocturnal visits had, however, bone no fruit.



The signal came down and the clanging of the bell announced the approaching train. Lady Lal hurriedly finished off her meal. She got up, still ticking the stone of the pickled mango. She went to the public tap to rinse her mouth and wash her hands. After washing she dried her mouth and hands with the loose end of her *sari* walked back to her steel trunk, thanking the gods for the favour of a filling meal.

The train steamed in Lachmi found herself facing an almost empty inter-class zenana compartment next to the guard's van at the tail end of the train. The rest of the train was packed. She heaved her squat, bulky frame through the door and found a seat by the window. She produced a two-anna bit from a knot in her *sari* and dismissed the coolie. She then opened her betel case and made herself two betel leaves charged with a red and white paste minced betelnuts and cardamoms. These she thrust into her mouth till her cheeks bulged on both sides. Then she rested her chin on her hands and sat gazing her chin on her hands and sat gazing idly at the **jostling** crowd on the platform.

The arrival of the train did not disturb Sir Mohan Lal's coolness. He continued to sip his scotch and ordered the bearer to tell him when he had moved the luggage to a first class compartment. Excitement, bustle and hurry were exhibitions of bad breeding and Sir Mohan was eminently well-bred. He wanted everything 'tickety-boo' and orderly. In his five years abroad, Sir Mohan of the upper classes. He rarely spoke Hindustani. When he did, it was like an Englishman's—only the very necessary

words and properly anglicised. But he fancied his English, finished and refined at no less a place than the university of Oxford.

He was fond of conversation, and like a cultured Englishman, he could talk on almost any subject—books, politics, people. How frequently had he heard English people say that he spoke like an Englishman!

Sir Mohan wondered if he could be travelling alone. It was a cantonment and some English officers might be on the train. His heart warmed at the prospect of an impressive conversation. He never showed any sign of eagerness to talk to the English as most Indians did. Nor was he loud, aggressive and opinionated like them. He went about his business with an expressionless matter of factness. He would retire to his corner by the window and get out a copy of the Times. He would fold it in a way in which the name of the paper was visible to others while he did the crossword puzzle. The Times always attracted attention. Someone would like to borrow it when he put it aside with a gesture signifying 'I've finished with it.' Perhaps someone would recognise his tie, which he always wore while travelling. That would open a **vista** leading to a fairyland of Oxford colleges, masters, dons, tutors, boat races and rugger matches. If both The Times and the tie failed, Sir Mohan would take out his handsome gold cigarette case filled with English cigarettes. English cigarettes in India? How on earth did he get them? Sure he didn't mind? And Sir Mohan's understanding smile—of course he didn't. But could he use the Englishman as a medium to commune with his dear old England? Those five years of grey **bags** and gowns, of sports blazers and mixed doubles, and of dinners at the Inns of court. Five years of a crowded glorious life. Worth far more than the forty-five in India with his dirty, vulgar countryman, with sordid details of the road to success.

Sir Mohan's thoughts were disturbed by the bearer announcing the installation of the Sahib's luggage in a first class **coupe** next to the engine. Sir Mohan walked to his coupe with a studied gait. He was dismayed. The compartment was empty. With a sigh he sat down in a corner and opened the copy of The Times, he had read several times before.

Sir Mohan looked out of the window down the crowded platform. His face lit up as he saw two English soldiers trudging along, looking in all the compartments for room.

They had their haversacks slung behind their backs and walked unsteadily. Sir Mohan decided to welcome them, even though they were entitled to travel only second class. He would speak to the guard.

One of the soldiers came up to the last compartment and stuck his face through the window. He surveyed the compartment and noticed the unoccupied berth.



‘Ere, Bill,’ he shouted ‘one’ ere’.

His companion came up, also looked in and looked at Sir Mohan.

‘Get’ in out,’ he muttered to his companion. They opened the door and turned to the half-smiling, half-protesting Sir Mohan ‘Reserved!’ yelled Bill.

‘Janta—Reserved. Army—Fauj, exclaimed Jim, pointing to his khaki shirt.

‘Ekdum jao—get out!’

‘I say, I say, surely,’ protested Sir Mohan in his Oxford accent. The soldiers paused. It almost sounded like English, but they knew better than to trust their inebriated ears. The engine whistled and the guard waved his green flag.

They picked up Sir Mohan’s suitcase and flung it into the platform. Then followed his thermos flask, suitcase, bedding and The Times. Sir Mohan was lived with rage.

‘Prosposterous, preposterous’, he shouted, ‘hoarse with anger. I’ll have you arrested—guard, guard!’

‘Bill and Jim paused again. It did sound like English, but it was too much of the King’s for them.

‘Keep your ruddy mouth shut!’ And Jim struck Sir Mohan flat on the face.

The engine gave another short whistle and the train began to move. The soldiers caught Sir Mohan by the arms and flung him out of the train. He reeled backwards, tripped on his bedding, and landed on the suitcase.

‘Toodle-Oo!’

Sir Mohan’s feet were glued to the earth and he lost his speech. He stared at the lighted windows of the train going past him in quickening tempo. The tail-end of the train appeared with a red light and the guard standing in the open doorway with the flags in his hands.

In the inter-class zenana compartment was Lachmi, fair and fat, on whose nose the diamond nose-ring glistened against the station lights. His mouth was bloated with beetle saliva which she had been storing up to spit as soon as the train had cleared the station. As the train sped past the lighted part of the platform, Lady Lal spot and sent a jet of red dribble flying across like a dart.

–Khushwant Singh

New Words to Learn



eau-de cologne : perfume made originally at France; **ek chota** : One small peg (of whisky); **ruminate** : think; **zenana** : carriage for women; **hawker** : one who carries and sells goods; **jostling** : knocking and pushing; **vista** : a long succession of remembered events; **bags** : trousers; **coupe** : a half compartment in a carriage; **kings** : the king's English correct proper English.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Art Integration

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Who is the writer of the story?

(a) Munshi Premchand

☐

(b) Khushwant Singh

☐

(c) Lachmi

☐

2. To whom with Lachmi was chatting?

(a) Coolie

☐

(b) Policeman

☐

(c) Passenger

☐

3. How was Sir Mohan Lal in nature?

(a) Greedy

☐

(b) Proud

☐

(c) Dirty

☐

4. Who is the hawker?

(a) Who carries household

☐

(b) Who carries and sells goods

☐

(c) Both (a) and (b)

☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. The _____ smiled back at Sir Mohan.
2. A bearer in white livery appeared through wire _____.
3. Right at the end of the _____.
4. Then I might as well get over the _____ of eating.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. bags
2. think
3. ek chota
4. eau de colonge
5. coupe

Column 'B'

- a. half compartment
- b. perfume
- c. one small peg
- d. ruminate
- e. trousers

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. How did Sir Mohan treat his wife?
2. What did Sir Mohan think about himself?
3. In what ways did Sir Mohan behave more like an Englishman than an Indian?
4. How do we know that Lady Lal is just a pleasant, ordinary of the train?
5. Why was Sir Mohan's calmness not disturbed by the arrival of the train.

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

Coordinating conjunctions :

Analyse

but, or, either/or neither/nor, yet, still, for,
so, not only/ but also, therefore, nevertheless

A. Make up your own compound sentences using these coordinating conjunctions :

but for either/or neither/nor yet not only/but also
so or nevertheless therefore still

Subordinating conjunctions :

after, when, as, while, till/until, before, if, as soon as, whenever, since, as long as, where, wherever, because, although.

B. Join the following pairs of sentences together using a different subordinating conjunctions in each sentence :

1. The shopkeeper went home. There were no customers.
2. The problem was difficult to solve. The clever boy had the answer very soon.
3. The shopkeeper kept the shop open. The last customer left.
4. You don't like chocolates. Don't buy any.
5. He arrived at the station. The train had left.
6. Santosh decided to go home early. He was very tired.
7. The men cannot do the work. They have no tools.
8. The children came home. They had thin dinner.
9. The teacher came into the room. The students stood up smartly.
10. He visited his parents. He took them presents.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- **Match the languages with the countries, and then find them all in the word square below (The words can appear forwards, backwards or diagonally. Yes, it's difficult)** Problem Solving

Languages

SWAHILI
HINDI
MANDARIN
HUNGARIAN
CREOLE
ARABIC
SOMALI
DUTCH
HAUSA
IRISH
MAGYAR
HEBREW

Countries

HUNGARY
NETHERLANDS
KENYA
NIGERIA
ZIMBABWE
IRAQ
HAITI
INDIA
ISRAEL
CHINA
SOMALIA
IRELAND

H	A	U	T	N	E	T	H	E	R	L	A	N	D	S
S	W	E	S	T	E	R	J	I	N	K	E	T	E	R
I	W	L	E	W	B	A	B	M	I	Z	I	U	Q	B
R	T	A	I	L	A	M	O	S	G	H	P	A	E	N
D	U	I	H	Q	W	M	A	G	Y	A	R	T	Y	I
U	X	D	A	I	S	A	M	Y	U	I	G	H	K	G
K	E	N	I	K	L	V	N	R	C	R	E	O	L	E
I	H	I	T	E	D	I	U	H	D	E	E	W	J	R
S	U	H	I	N	D	I	B	E	A	L	S	I	P	I
H	N	T	A	Y	Q	A	I	B	E	A	H	B	V	A
O	G	O	M	A	N	D	A	R	I	N	A	C	S	E
N	A	L	N	I	S	X	N	E	S	D	U	T	C	H
A	R	G	H	A	F	R	I	W	L	U	S	Y	T	F
I	Y	C	I	L	E	A	G	I	S	R	A	E	L	R

LET'S WRITE

- Write a short account about robots in general or about a particular robot that you would like to own.

Writing Skills

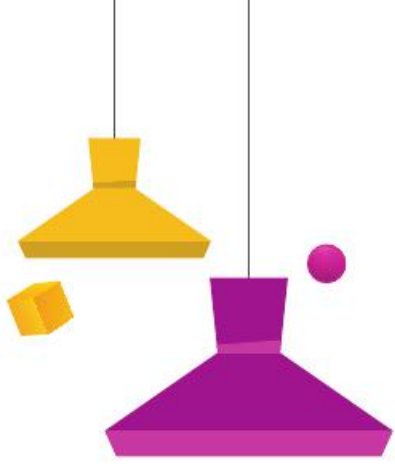
Activity Time



- Fill in the blanks with ie or ei. Check the words in a dictionary if you are in doubt :

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. perc ____ ve | 2. dec ____ ve |
| 3. rec ____ pty | 4. ch ____ f |
| 5. h ____ ght | 6. gr ____ f |
| 7. sh ____ kh | 8. bel ____ ve |
| 9. f ____ ld | 10. s ____ ve |
| 11. rec ____ ve | 12. rel ____ ve |

Critical Thinking

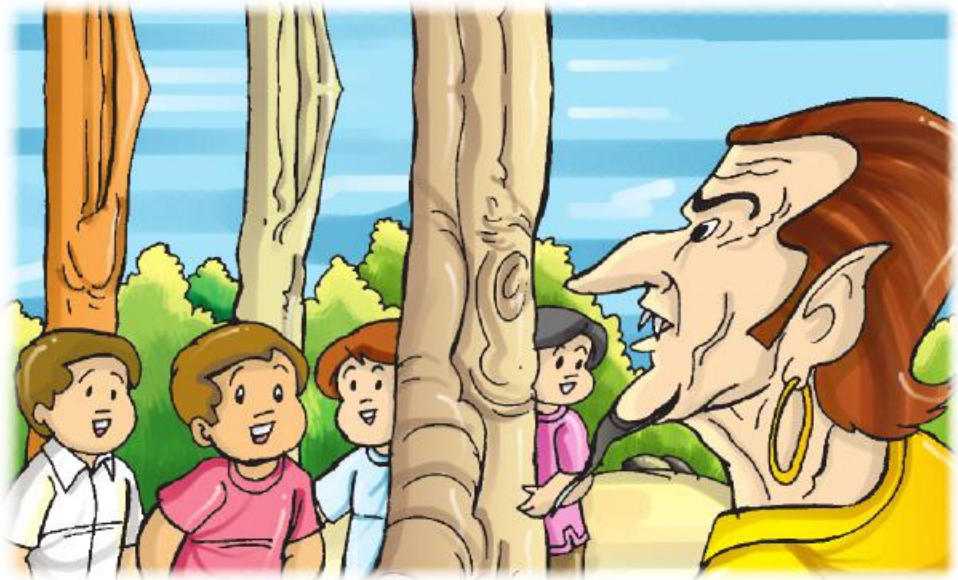


11

The Selfish Giant

Every afternoon, as they were coming from school, the children used to go and play in the Giant's garden.

It was a large lovely garden, with soft green grass. Here and there over the grass stood beautiful flowers like stars, and there were twelve peach trees that in the springtime broke out into delicate blossoms of pink and pearl, and in the autumn bore rich fruits. The birds sat on the trees and sang so sweetly that



the children used to stop their games in order to listen to them. 'How happy we are here!' they cried to each other.

One day the Giant came back. He had been to visit his friend, the **Cornish Ogre**, and had stayed with him for seven years. When he arrived, he saw the children playing in the garden.

"What are you doing here?" he cried in a very gruff voice, and the children ran away.

"My own garden is my own garden," said the Giant. "anyone can understand that, and I will allow nobody to play in it but myself." So he built a high wall all round it, and put up a notice-board:

He was a very Selfish Giant.

The poor children had now nowhere to play. They tried to play on the road, but the road was very dusty and full of hard stones, and they did not like it. They used to wander round the high walls when their lessons were over, and talk about the beautiful garden inside. "How happy we were there!" they said to each other.

Then the Spring came, and all over the country there were little blossoms and little birds. Only in the garden of the Selfish Giant it was still winter. The birds did not care to sing in it as there were no children and the trees forgot to blossom. Once a beautiful flower put its head out from the grass, but when it saw the notice-board it was so sorry for the children that it slipped back into the ground again and went off to sleep. The only people who were pleased were the Snow and the Frost. "Spring has forgotten this garden." They cried so we will live here all the year round. The Snow covered up the grass with her great cloak, and the Frost painted all the trees silver. Then they invited the North Wind to stay with them, and he came. He was wrapped in furs, and he roared all day about the garden and blew the chimney pots down. "This is delightful spot," he said, "we must ask Hail on a visit." So the Hail came 'Everyday for three hours he rattled on the roof of the castle till he broke most of the slates, and he ran round and round the garden as fast as he could go. He was dressed in grey, and his breath was like ice.'

"I cannot understand why the Spring is so late in coming," said the Selfish Giant, as he sat at the window and looked out at his cold, white garden, "I hope there will be a change in the weather."

But the Spring never came, nor the Summer. The Autumn gave golden fruit to every garden, but to the Giant's garden she gave none. "He is too selfish," she said. So it was always Winter there, and the North Wind and the Hail, and the Frost, and the Snow danced about through the trees.

One morning the Giant was lying awake in bed when he heard some lovely music. It sounded so sweet to his ears that he thought it must be the King's musicians passing by. It was really only a little linnet singing outside his window, but it was so long since he had heard a bird singing in his garden that it seemed to him to be the most beautiful music in the world. Then the Hail stopped dancing over his head and the North Wind ceased roaring, and a delicious perfume came to him through the open casement. "I believe the Spring has come at last," said the Giant; and he jumped out of bed and looked out.

He saw a most beautiful sight. Through a little hole in the wall the children had crept in, and they were sitting in the branches of the trees. In every tree that he could see there was a little child. And the trees were so glad to have the children back again that they covered themselves with blossoms, and were waving their arms gently above the children's heads.



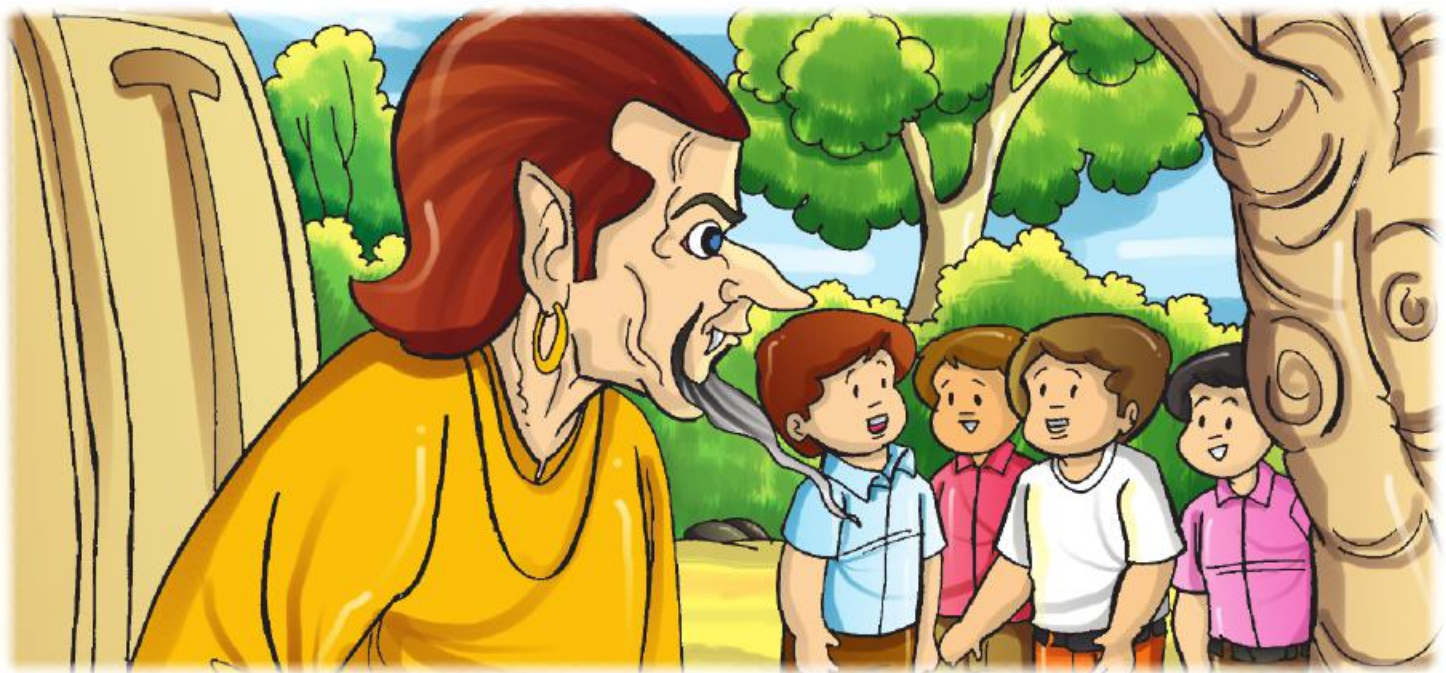
The birds were flying about and twittering with delight, and the flowers were looking up through the green grass and laughing. It was a lovely scene. Only in one corner it was still winter. It was the farthest corner of the garden, and in it was standing a little boy. He was so small that he could not reach up the branches of the tree, and he was wandering all round it, crying bitterly. The poor tree was still covered with Frost and Snow, and North Wind was blowing and roaring above it. "Climb up, little boy!" said the Tree, and it bent its branches down as low as it could; but the boy was too tiny.

And the Giant's heart melted as he looked out. "How selfish I have been!" he said, "now I know why the Spring would not come here. I will put that poor little boy on the top of the tree and then I will knock down the wall, and my garden shall be the children's playground for ever and ever. He was really very sorry for what he had done. So he crept downstairs and opened the front door quite softly, and went out into the garden. But when the children saw him, they were so frightened that they all ran away, and the garden became winter again. Only the little boy did not run, for his eyes were so full of tears that he did not see the Giant coming. And the Giant **stole up** behind him and took him gently in his hands, put him up into the tree. And the tree

broke at once into blossom, and the birds came and sang on it, and little boy stretched out his two arms and flung them, round the Giant's neck and kissed him. And the other children when they saw that the Giant was not wicked any longer, came running back, and with them came the Spring. "It is your garden now, little children," said the Giant and he took a great axe and knocked down the wall. And when the people were going to market at twelve o'clock they found the Giant playing with the children in the most beautiful garden they had ever seen.



All day long they played and in the evening they came to the Giant to led him good-bye. "But where is your little companion?" he said, "the boy I put into the tree?" The Giant loved him the best because he had kissed him.



"We don't know, answered the children." "He has gone away." "You must tell him to be sure and come tomorrow," said the Giant. But the children said that they did not know where he lived and had never seen him before, and the Giant felt very sad.

Every afternoon, when school was over, the children came and played with the Giant. But the little boy whom the Giant loved was never seen again. The Giant was very kind to all the children, yet he longed for his little friend and often spoke of him. "How I would like to see him!" he used to say.

Years went by, and the Giant grew very old and **feeble**. He could not play about anymore, so he sat in a huge armchair and watched children at their games and admired his garden. "I have many beautiful flowers," he said, "but the children are the most beautiful flowers of all."

One winter morning he looked out of his window as he was dressing. He did not hate the Winter now, for he knew that it was merely the Spring asleep, and that the flowers were resting.

Suddenly, he rubbed his eyes in wonder and looked and looked. It certainly was a marvellous sight. In the farthest corner of the garden was a tree quite covered with lovely white blossoms. Its branches were golden, and silver fruits hung down from them, and underneath it stood the little boy he had loved.

Downstairs ran the Giant in great joy, and out into the garden. He hastened across the grass and came near to the child and when he came quite closer, his face grew red with anger and he said, "Who hath dared to wound thee?" For on the palms of the child's hands were the prints of two nails, and the prints of two nails were on the little feet.

"Who hath dared to wound thee?" cried the Giant; "tell me, that I may take my big sword and **slay** him.

"**Nay!**" answered the child. "but these are the wounds of love." "Who art thou?" said the Giant and a strange awefull on him, and he knelt before the little child.

And the child smiled on the Giant and said to him, you let me play once in your garden; today you shall come with me to my garden, which is paradise.

And when the children ran in that afternoon, they found the Giant lying dead under the tree, all covered with white blossoms.

—Oscar Wilde

New Words to Learn



Cornish Ogre : a giant of Cornwall (in U.K.); **stole up** : came quietly without being noticed; **slay** : Kill; **nay** : No; **feeble** : weak.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Who did not enter the garden?

(a) Giant

(b) Children

(c) Outsiders

2. How many peach trees were there in the garden?

(a) Eleven

(b) Twelve

(c) Thirteen

3. Who is the author of the story?

(a) Charles Dickens

(b) Oscar Wilde

(c) Munshi Premchand

4. Where did children use to go and play?

(a) In the Giant's terrace

(b) In the Giant's garden

(c) In the Giant's house

5. What was written on the notice-board?

(a) Everybody is allowed

(b) Trespassers will be prosecuted

(c) Only (a)

B. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. slay

2. nay

3. feeble

4. stole up

5. Giant

Column 'B'

a. great size

b. weak

c. came quietly without being noticed

d. no

e. kill

C. Fill in the blanks :

1. It was a large lovely _____ with soft green grass.

2. 'How happy we are here!' they _____ to each other.

3. He was a very _____ Giant.

4. Only in the _____ of the _____ it was still winter.
5. But the _____ never came, nor the summer.

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. Why was the Giant selfish?
2. What did he see when the Giant came back?
3. Describe how was the garden?
4. What did Giant realise after seeing the most beautiful sight?
5. Why did the Spring never come back?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

• **Read the following sentences :**

Analyse

- It **appeared** as if I **had known** them for years.
- I vaguely **felt I had wronged** her and her parents.
- Both parents **apologized** because they had not her parents.
- She **mentioned** the plans he **had outlined** to her and her husband.

Notice that in each sentence, the verbs are coloured. One verb (in each sentence) is in the simple past tense and one verb is in the past perfect tense.

Here is a table to remind you of all the tenses :

I	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	I sit.	I am sitting.	I have sat.	I have been sitting.
Past	I sat.	I was sitting.	I had sat.	I had been sitting.
Future	I shall. sit.	I shall. be sitting.	I shall. have sat.	I shall have been. sitting.

Make a similar table for the verbs 'talk' and 'drink'. Then make a table for the verb 'sing' using the third person singular 'he' instead of the first person singular 'I'.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

The verbs **had known**, **had wronged**, **had noticed** and **had outlined** in the sentences on the previous pages are all in the past perfect tense.

We use the **past perfect tense** to speak of an action that took place before another action in the past.

Example: The man helped the old lady.

The lady fell off the bus.

The man helped the old lady who had **fallen** off the bus.

First, the lady fell off the bus, then the man helped her. Both actions took place in the past, but one (helping) took place after the other (falling)

• **Fill in the blanks with the simple past or the past perfect forms of the verbs given in brackets :**

- a. I _____ the biscuits by the time, the children _____. (*eat, arrive*)
- b. By the time, she _____ to the time, the children _____. (*eat, arrive*)
- c. When we _____ the hall, the film _____ and we missed the beginning. (*reach, start*)
- d. I wish they _____ in their applications earlier. (*reach, start*)
- e. They _____ there two minutes when the display _____. (*not be, begin*)
- f. The dog _____ hungry, it _____ anything for two days. (*be, not eat*)
- g. I _____ still weak as I _____ a cold the previous week. (*be, have*)
- h. The students _____ the lesson after the teacher _____ it to them. (*understand, explain*)

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. Colloquialisms

Critical Thinking

Informally we use certain words in a way that does not correspond to their real meaning. Such expressions are used colloquially, in conversation rather than in written English.

For example, we may say, 'She is terribly kind!' If you look up the word 'terribly' in a dictionary you will see it has two quite different meanings, one of which colloquially, as in the example.

Can you use the following in two ways to bring out their different meanings?

1. horribly 2. awfully 3. frightfully 4. pretty

B. Complete the well known similies :

Problem Solving

- | | | | |
|-----------------|----------------------|----------------|----------------------|
| 1. as bright | <input type="text"/> | 2. as fit | <input type="text"/> |
| 3. as brown | <input type="text"/> | 4. as gaudy | <input type="text"/> |
| 5. as dead | <input type="text"/> | 6. as harmless | <input type="text"/> |
| 7. as different | <input type="text"/> | 8. as heavy | <input type="text"/> |
| 9. as fat | <input type="text"/> | 10. as brittle | <input type="text"/> |

LET'S WRITE

- Write five points on the topic '**Working Mom's**' :

Writing Skills

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Activity Time



- A. In a group of three or four, search from internet or go through the books available in your school library and find out what do the following abbreviations stand for?

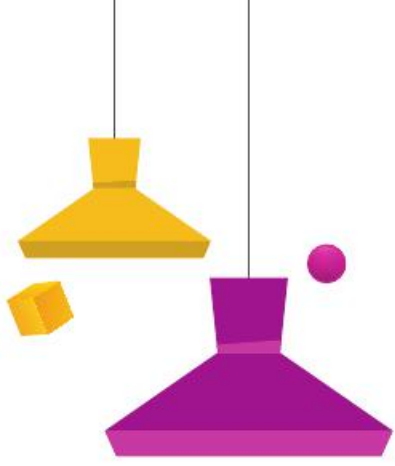
Creativity

1. assoc _____
2. Dept _____
3. a/c _____
4. B.Sc _____
5. H.E _____
6. I.S.T _____

- B. Write any five wishes which are you want to fulfill :

Writing Skills

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____



12

No Longer Helpless

I was lost, but literacy found me. Looking back now, as I hold this chalk over my slate, I feel things could have been different and better had I learnt to do the same many years ago. Life was terrifying before, letters and numbers everywhere, in every signboard and every newspaper. It was a life of dependency and I used my children as a **crutch**, a



time when they probably should have depended on me, more than I on them. Looking back on that time, I feel that it was unfair on my part, but what could I do? I was helpless and illiterate. It was a time when the thumb was my best friend. I put the thumb impressions for paying rents and other things, which could so easily have been done by the pen. Lately I realised that I just could not thumb my hands at my fate or what I believed my inherited destiny.

But all this was **poised** for a change when a group of conscious people came and held a loft the bright luminous torch of literacy. I was motivated even at my age and this was a golden opportunity for me to learn how to read and write and more than that to hold my head high in dignity and self-respect in the secure knowledge that I had gained entry into the **ranks** of the **neo-literate**. These literacy classes are so much a part of my existence now that I feel empty if I miss out on even one evening.



There is one thing that had taught me, it is to meet my personal targets. For the sense of joy in learning new experiences **overwhelms** all the feelings of **tedium** and laziness that I experience sometimes. My greatest sense of pride, joy and achievement is when I find myself able to help my grandchildren in their studies. This is something which are unthinkable a few years ago.

Out in the world and in the streets where I help out at a local teashop, I am able to maintain calculations and to draw up a rough and ready budget for my daily expenses.

Earlier I used to ask people to write their expenses in my bill book. Many a times, I was underpaid, cheated, and the only way I could keep track of the money that was owed to me was by identifying such people by a beard they kept, a moustache they sported, their hairstyle, etc. Today even at home, I am able to calculate my savings put it in the banks, make estimates and generally it has helped me to live a life of honour and self-reliance and not one of debt and



perpetual dependence. I need not rely on other people to write and read for me. I need not spend uselessly to get these things done for me. Why? Because I am able to do these on my own. I need not be lost any more, I can read signboards and I rarely blush in embarrassment as before. Today I can proudly announce to the world that my blush has been replaced by a confident smile. I will remain ever grateful to all of you who are responsible for giving me a second chance—a chance to lead a better life.

I was lost, but literacy found me... and for that I will continue to learn and I also urge my fellow sisters and brothers to join me in this wonderful lifelong experience of learning.

—Sonali Kumar

New Words to Learn



crutch : support; **poised** : in a state of readiness to act or move; **ranks** : class or group; **neo-literate** : those who recently learning to read and write; **overwhelms** : completely overcomes; **tedium** : feeling that something is long and tiring; **perceptual** : way people understand.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. She was lost, what did she find her?

(a) Illiteracy

(b) Literacy

(c) None of these

2. What was her best friend?

(a) Legs

(b) Fingers

(c) Thumb

5. Who is the author of the story?

(a) Sonali Doshi

(b) Sonali Kumar

(c) Sonali Dewan

4. What had replaced her blush in embarrassment?

(a) Confident walk

(b) Confident smile

(c) (a) and (b) both

3. What all work she can do at the teashop?

(a) Maintain calculations

(b) Draw up a rough and ready budget

(c) both (a) and (b)

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. This is something which are _____ a few years ago.
2. I had gained entry into the _____ of the neo-literate.
3. I was lost, but _____ found me.
4. It was a time when the _____ was my best friend.
5. Because I am able to do these on my _____.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. crutch
2. ranks
3. neo-literate
4. perceptual
5. over whelms

Column 'B'

- a. who recently learn to read and write
- b. completely overcomes
- c. way people understand
- d. class or group
- e. support

Writing Skills

D. Answer the following questions :

1. Why did Kong Cecilia grateful for leading a better life?
2. When were the class held?
3. Define the term 'literacy'?
4. Who provided her with this opportunity?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

Here is a table showing what changes occur in reported speech.

Direct	Indirect
"I write", he said;	He said that he wrote.
"I am writing;"	He was writing.
"I have written;"	He had written.
"I shall write;"	He would write.
"I shall have written;"	He would have written.

• **Change the following into reported speech :**

1. "I hope you don't mind," she said.
(There is no need to write she said; she hoped. She hoped will do.)
2. "Where have you been?" the man asked her.
3. Prakash asked the boy, "If you never try a new thing, how can you know what it's like?"
4. "I didn't find out whether they had seen the film"; said Mohan to his wife, when they returned home.
5. "Father, have you any idea at all of what's going on?" Jasbir asked in a hushed voice.
6. "I don't know what's happening, Jasbir, but we are finding, out;" replied the father.
7. "And you paid for the house with all this gold and all these diamonds!" exclaimed the boy. (to the old woman)
8. "It will disappear in a flash!" protested Maya.

Hint: A question becomes a statement in reported speech.

"Is this the right house?" she asked.

She asked if that (it) was the right house.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. With the help of your dictionary, explain the difference in meaning between the words in each pair given below :

Critical Thinking

1. strategist; analyst _____
2. crevasse; chasm _____
3. gradually; slowly _____
4. exposed; naked _____
5. scrambling; crawling _____
6. ceded; surrendered _____

B. Add suitable adjectives to the following nouns :

Problem Solving

- | | |
|------------------|----------------------|
| 1. _____ heights | 2. _____ frostbite |
| 3. _____ camp | 4. _____ environment |
| 5. _____ chasm | 6. _____ leadership |
| 7. _____ waste | 8. _____ disaster |

LET'S WRITE

- Write an article in around 150 words on the topic, 'All work is dignified'. It will be going to be published in your school's Annual magazine. Writing Skills

Activity Time

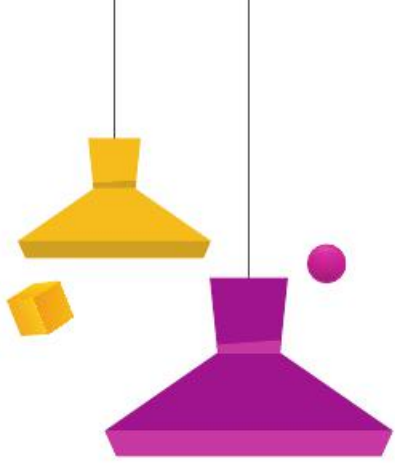


- A. In pair of two or three, write down all the important dates since freedom like 15th August, 1947, for examples: Critical Thinking

15 August, 1947 _____

26 January, 1949 _____

- B. Paste three pictures of Our National Symbols in the space provided : Art Integration



13

A Visit to Cambridge

Cambridge was my metaphor for England, and it was strange that when I left it had become altogether something else, because I had met Stephen Hawking there.

It was on a walking tour through Cambridge that the guide mentioned Stephen Hawking, 'poor man, who is quite disabled now, though he is a worthy successor to Issac Newton, whose Chair he has at the university'.

And I started because I had quite forgotten that this most brilliant and completely paralysed **astrophysicist**, the author of *A Brief History of Time*, one of the biggest best-sellers ever, lived here.



When the walking tour was done, I rushed to a phone booth and, almost tearing the cord so it could reach me outside, phoned Stephen Hawking's house. There was his assistant on the line and I told him I had come in a wheelchair from India (perhaps he thought I had propelled myself all the way) to write about my travels in Britain. I had to see Professor Hawking—even ten minutes would do "Half an hour", he said. "From three-thirty to four."

And suddenly I felt weak all over. Growing up disabled, you get fed up with people asking you to be brave, as if you have a courage account on which you are too lazy to draw a cheque. The only thing that makes you stronger is seeing somebody like you, achieving something huge. Then you know how much is possible and you reach out

further than you ever thought you could.

“I have not been brave,” said his disembodied computer-voice, the next afternoon. “I have had no choice.”

Surely, I wanted to say, living creatively with the reality of his disintegrating body was a choice? But I kept quiet, because I felt guilty every time I spoke to him, forcing him to respond. There he was, tapping at the little switch in his hand, trying to find the words on his computer with the only bit of movement left to him, his long, pale fingers. Every so often, his eyes would shut in frustrated exhaustion. And sitting opposite him I could feel his anguish, the mind **buoyant** with thoughts that came out in frozen phrases and sentences stiff as corpses.

“A lot of people seem to think that disabled people are chronically unhappy,” I said. “I know that is not true myself. Are you often laughing inside?”

About three minutes later, he responded, “I find it amusing when people patronise me.”

“And do you find it annoying when someone like me comes and disturbs you in your work?”

The answer flashed, “Yes.” Then he smiled his one-way smile and I knew, without being sentimental or silly, that I was looking at one of the most beautiful men in the world.

A first glimpse of him is shocking because he is like a still photograph—as if all those pictures of him in magazines and newspapers have turned three-dimensional.

Then you see the head twisted sideways into a slump, the **torso** shrunk inside the pale blue shirt, the wasted legs; you look at his eyes which can speak, still and they are saying something huge and urgent—it is hard to tell what. But you are shaken because you have seen something you never thought could be seen.

Before you, like a lantern whose walls are worn so then you glimpse only the light inside, is the **incandescence** of a man. The body, almost irrelevant, exists only like a case made of shadows. So that I, no believer in eternal souls, know that this is what each of us is, everything else an **accessory**.

“What do you think is the best thing about being disabled?” I had asked him earlier.

“I don’t think there is anything good about being disabled.”

"I think," I said, "You do discover how much kindness there is in the world."

"Yes," he said; it was a disadvantage of his voice synthesiser that it could convey no **inflection**, no shades or tone. And I could not tell how enthusiastically he agreed with me.

Every time I shifted in my chair or turned my wrist to watch the time—I wanted to make everyone of our thirty minutes count—I felt a huge relief and exhilaration in the possibilities of my body. How little it mattered then that I would never walk, or even stand.

I told him how he had been an inspiration beyond **cliche** for me, and surely, for others—did that thought help him?

"No," he said; and I thought how foolish I was to ask. When your body is a **claustrophobic** room and the walls are growing narrower day by day, it does not do much good to know that there are people outside smiling with admiration to see you breathing still.

"Is there any advice you can give disabled people, something that might help make life better?" "They should concentrate on what they are good at, I think things like the disabled Olympics are a waste of time."

"I know what you mean." I remembered the years I had spent trying to play a Spanish guitar considerably larger than I was, and how gleefully I had unstrung it one night. The half-hour was set up, "I think I have annoyed you enough", I said, grinning. "Thank you for..."

"Stay, I waited. Have some tea. I can show you the garden." The garden was as big as a park, but Stephen Hawking covered every inch, rumbling along in his motorised wheelchair while I dodged to keep out of the way. We could not talk very much, the sun made him silent, the letters on his screen disappearing in the glare.

An hour later, we were ready to leave. I did not know what to do. I could not kiss him or cry. I touched his shoulder and wheeled out into the summer evening. I looked back and I knew that he was waving, though he was not watching him, an embodiment of my bravest self, the one I was moving towards, the one I had believed in for so many years, alone, I knew that my journey was over for now.

—Firdaus Kanga

(From Heaven on Wheels)



astrophysicist : who studies astrophysics; **buoyant** : intensely active and vibrant; **torso** : upper part of the body; **incandescence** : Inner glow or light; **accessory** : not essential but extra through decorative; **inflection** : rise and fall of the voice in speaking; **cliche** : phrase or idea used so often that it loses to meaning; **claustrophobic** : very small and suffocating.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- How much time did the author get?
 (a) One hour ☐ (b) Half an hour ☐ (c) Two hour ☐
- Who is the author of the story?
 (a) Firdaus Khad ☐
 (b) Firdaus Kanga ☐
 (c) Firdaus Khanum ☐
- To whom did the author meet at Cambridge?
 (a) Charles Hawking's ☐
 (b) Stephen Hawkings ☐
 (c) Tom Hawkings ☐
- Whom successor was Stephen Hawking?
 (a) Einstein ☐ (b) Issac Newton ☐ (c) Tom Jerry ☐

B. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

- buoyant
- torso
- incandescence
- claustrophobic
- askrophyscist

Column 'B'

- who studies astrophysics
- Innerglow or light
- very small and suffocating
- upper part of the body.
- intensely actur and vibrant

C. Fill in the blanks:

- Cambridge was my _____ for England it was strange.

2. The author of a brief _____, one of the biggest best-sellers ever, lived here.
3. A lot of people seem to think that _____ people are chronically unhappy.
4. I don't think there is _____ good about being disabled.
5. An hour later, we were _____ to know.

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. To whom was the writer eager to meet?
2. Why was the writer nervous?
3. What does this line mean. "I could fill his anguish?"
4. What was the first question asked by the writer to the scientist?
5. Did the writer think there was a choice? What was it?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

A. Turn the following sentences into direct speech.

Analyse

Example: The long-nosed one commented that an aeroplane with a speed of 10,000 miles an hour has been built!

'An aeroplane with a speed of 10,000 miles an hour has been built!' commented the long-nosed one.

1. The people asked what the long-nosed one says about this.
2. The long-nosed one asked in his own tongue why he should join party and parties.
3. The long-nosed one asked why he should join any party.
4. The loudspeakers blared forth that people must be disciplined.
5. The doctors gave their unanimous verdict that the nose was not made of rubber.

B. Change the coloured phrases by completing the sentence with the clue word. Do not change the meaning of the sentences :

1. The people wanted to know **the long-nosed one's response**.

The people wanted to know what _____

2. This is **his destiny**.

This is where _____

3. The long-nosed one said **something about the future being bright**.

The long-nosed one said that _____

C. Fill in the blanks with may or might. Follow the instructions given in brackets.

Example: The football match _____ be cancelled. (*probability*)

The football match may be cancelled.

1. If we watch TV too long, we _____ get into trouble. (*possibility*)
2. If she saves enough, she _____ just make it to Chennai. (*weak possibility*)
3. _____ you live a long life and have many children (*wishes*).
4. _____ I have some sugar in my tea, if you have any in the house? (*a polite suggestion*)
5. They asked if they _____ borrow our cat. (*a polite request*)

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

A. Abbreviate the following; insert apostrophes in the right places :

Problem Solving

1. the chairs of the very Important Persons.
2. the office of the Deputy Inspector General.
3. the pens of the Regional Transport Officers.
4. the supporters of the Member of Parliament.

B. Add suffixes -ful, -y, -ish, -ous :

Critical Thinking

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| 1. hope _____ | 2. care _____ |
| 3. dough _____ | 6. dirt _____ |
| 5. girl _____ | 6. youth _____ |
| 7. poison _____ | 8. fancy _____ |

LET'S WRITE

• **Match the column to make a poem:**

- | | |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. Those are my eyes | a. just beneath |
| 2. This is my chin | b. and that is my nose |
| 3. This is my mouth | c. rather neatly |
| 4. Fitted within | d. them when I grin wide |
| 5. Those are my ears | e. on either side |
| 6. My mouth reaches | f. these are my teeth |
| 7. The jigsaw fits in | g. sight above |
| 8. This is my face | h. don't you see? |

Activity Time



- **Family trees**

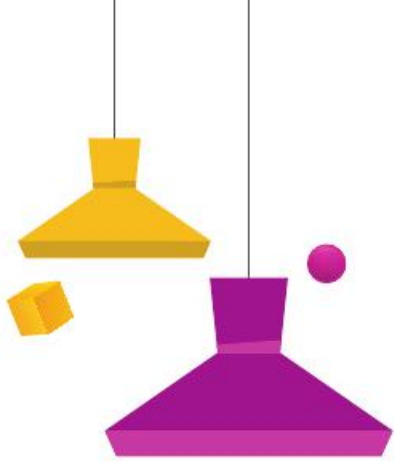
Here are some words we use when talking about members of our family:

mother, father, uncle, aunt, brother, sister, grandfather

Draw a family tree and past the pictures of your family members :

Art Integration

A large, empty rounded rectangle with a thin blue border, intended for a student to draw a family tree and paste pictures of family members.



14 An Old Man's Ageless Wisdom

Odisha, is a state with beautiful, thick forests and the famous Chilika Lake. It is well-known for its great temples. The Puri Jagannath Temple and the Sun Temple of Konark are among the most remarkable achievements of ancient India. They are also **landmark** attractions for tourists.

However, there is lot of poverty in Odisha and there are some 13,500 **NGO's** working in the state to help the poorest of the poor.

This is a state where many tribal people dwell in the deep interiors. The women wear brightly coloured *sarees*—leaf green, bright yellow, dark red—and simply knot their jet black hair with fresh flowers tucked in. It is a delight to see them when you are travelling inside the forests.

I chose to travel to Kalahandi. It is neither a town nor a city, and it is not known for anything special. It is just another part of another tribal district like Mayur Bhunj or Koraput.



Jagannath Temple



Sun Temple

They say that before independence Kalahandi was ruled by a king. The tribals believe that the king was a man with supreme powers and their caretaker. They are so innocent that even today they do not believe you if you tell them that 'kings' no longer exist. Even now, if a child is orphaned, it will be left at the door of the collector's house. For them the ultimate protector is the Raja.

Bhavani Pattanam is the district headquarters of Kalahandi. It is not like other district headquarter. It is a small town, quite different from the district headquarters that I know, Dharwad for example, which is my home town. Frankly I was surprised that Bhavani Pattanam was such a sleepy town.



I was travelling with a person who was with me in order to help me talk to the locals. Knowledge of the local language is more essential when you want to work at the grass roots level.

I had a thousand questions to ask about these tribal people—what civilisation meant to them, what their life style was like, and so on. Normally they are group dwellers. They are not too rigid about rituals like we 'civilised' people are. They are direct in their ways. Most importantly, they do not have the concept of individual ownership of property. My mission was to provide assistance to them by some means, without hurting their identity.

My translator told me that if I had to meet these people then I would have to walk two miles. Obviously, there was no motorable road to reach their hamlet. I was ready.

We finally reached a village where I met a lady whose age I could not immediately make out. My translator found it difficult to translate the lady's words because her

dialect was quite different. She was a dark skinned and dark-haired lady. She must have been around seventy years old but there was no grey in her hair. She obviously could not afford to dye her hair. So what was her secret? Nobody knew. It must have been a 'secret' common to all for not one person in that whole village had a trace of grey hair.

I next met an old man. I say old, but again it was impossible to guess his age by his looks. During our conversation, he recall certain events and occasions from which we concluded that he was about 104 years old.

I got into a lively conversation with this gentleman. I asked him, 'Who is ruling our country?' For him 'country' clearly meant Kalahandi. He looked at me and smiled at my ignorance. "Don't you know?" he said. "It is a company *sarcar* that is ruling our country." He meant of course that East India Company. The old man was not aware that India had become independent'.

I showed him some Indian currency and the Ashoka Chakra emblem. He was not impressed. He said, 'That is just a piece of paper. How can you look at it and tell who is ruling us? It is '**Goriwali Rani**' who is ruling us.

I knew that the barter system was very important to the tribal people. So I asked him about it. "Do you know this small, piece of paper can buy firewood, lots of *sarees*, bags of salt and plenty of matchsticks?" I remarked.

He looked at me sympathetically and said, 'For this paper, people fight, go away from our ancestral land, leave our forest and go to cities? Without that piece of paper, have we not led a complete life? Our ancestors did."

"We are children of God, settled here happily without this paper. This is God's land. Nobody owns their land. No river has been created by us. No mountain is made by us. The wind does not listen to us. The rain does not ask our permission. These are gifts of God. How we can 'sell' or 'buy' land, I do not understand. When nothing is yours then how can you make such **transactions**? This little paper of yours can turn our lives upside down."

I had no words by way of a reply. Until that moment, I was convinced that I knew more than I did.

We know about currency movements, political parties, about the difference between Bill Gates and Bill Clinton. Here was a man who knew nothing of these, yet knew that nobody owned the land, the mountain or the wind.

Who is more civilised—this **wizened** old man in the Kalahandi forest or those of us with our fingers on the **pulse** of the Internet?

—Sudha Murthy

New Words to Learn



landmark : (*here*) a building that helps us recognise a place; **NGO** : Non Governmental Organisation; **caretaker** : a person who looks after a place **Headquarters** : the place from where an organisation is controlled; **grass root** : Ordinary people; **group dwellers** : person who live together in a community; **mission** : a particular work which you feel is your duty to do; **hamlet** : very small village **dialect** : form of language spoken in a particular area; **transactions** : piece of business that are done between people, especially act of buying or selling; **wizened** : looking smaller and having many folds and lines in the skin because of being old; **pulse** : (*here*) keeping in touch with all that is happening on the internet.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- Which one of them is the district headquarters of Kalahandi.
(a) Pataal Bhairvi ☐ (b) Bhavani Pattanam ☐ (c) None of these ☐
- Which famous lake is in Odisha?
(a) Dal Lake ☐ (b) Chilika Lake ☐ (c) Sukhna Lake ☐
- How many NGO's are there in Odisha?
(a) 13,000 ☐ (b) 13,500 ☐ (c) 14,000 ☐
- Who is the writer of 'An Old Man's Ageless Wisdom'?
(a) Sudhir Mishra ☐ (b) Sudha Murthy ☐ (c) Narayan Murthy ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

- They are also _____ attractions for tourists.
- It is not like other district _____.
- Normally they are _____ dwellers.
- I got into a lively _____ with his gentleman.
- The old man was not aware that _____ had become independent.

C. Match the **Column 'A'** with **Column 'B'** :

Column 'A'

1. ngo
2. grass root
3. hamlet
4. group dwellers
5. pulse

Column 'B'

- a. keeping in touch
- b. person who live together
- c. very small village
- d. ordinary people
- e. non-government organization

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. Why was the writer not able to make out the age of village people?
2. What was the old man ageless wisdom is?
3. Write about Odisha in four lines.
4. How can you say that the writer became a changed person after meeting with the old man?
5. What was the reason that writer chose Kalahandi to do his social work?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

• Study this sentence.

Analyse

In English two or more adverbs can be joined together to form an idiomatic phrase.

Examples: through and through

Find out what is meant by each of the following phrases. Use them in sentences of your own. Note that the order of each of the adverbs is fixed.

Example: By and large cannot be written as **large any by**.

Example: By and large cannot be written as **large and by**.

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. again and again | 2. here and there |
| 3. on and on | 4. off and on |
| 5. for and wide | 6. now and again |
| 7. round and round | 8. by and large |
| 9. in and out | 10. out and out |
| 11. to and fro | 12. first and foremost |
| 13. by and by | 14. through and through |

15. far and away

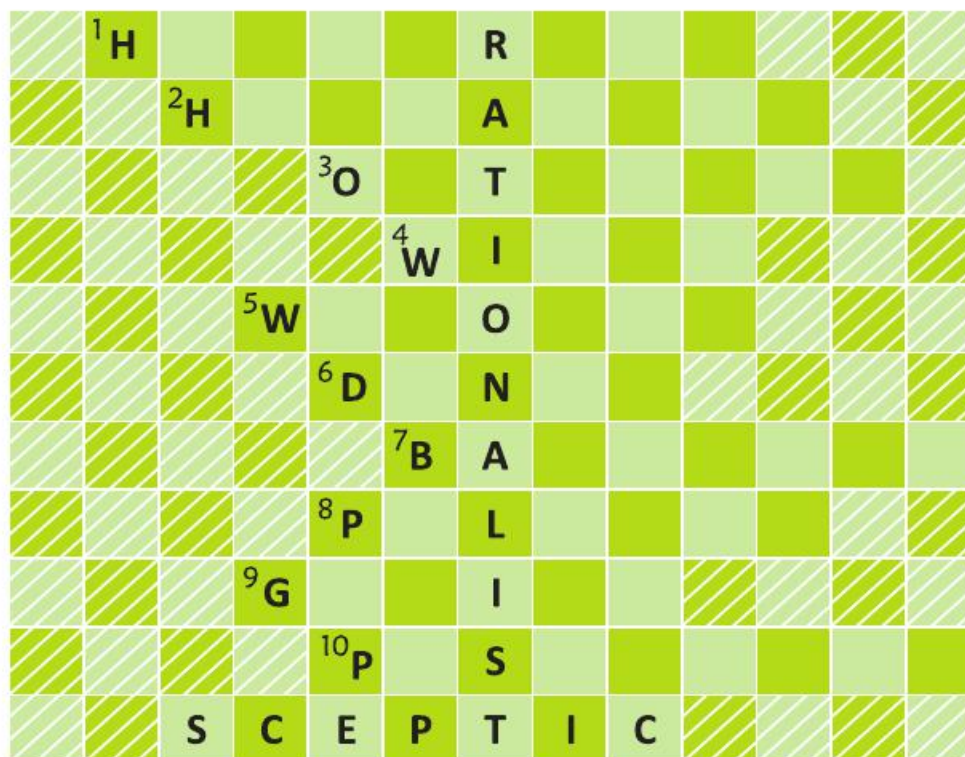
16. more or less

17. over and over

18. up and about.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- With the help of your dictionary, find out what name we give to each type of person described below fill in the crossword grid with the words you have found : Problem Solving



Hint: A person who is critical and always questions the truth of facts is called a **sceptic**.

A person who believes that **reason** is the foundation of certainty in knowledge is called a **rationalist**.

1. A person who says one thing and does another.
2. One skilled in the knowledge of or dealing with plants/ herbs.
3. A person who looks on the bright side of life.
4. A woman whose husband is dead.
5. A man whose wife is dead.
6. One who gives others (goods, money etc) as charity.
7. An unmarried man.
8. One who journeys to a holy place.
9. One who is extremely intelligent.
10. One who looks at the dark side of thing.

LET'S WRITE

- Choose three or four emotions and try to write a few lines reflecting each emotion you have chosen. Alter your style of writing to suit the emotions you are describing. **Problem Solving**

Here are some 'qualities' or 'emotions'; but you may choose to describe other if you wish:

terror
sadness

fury
doubt

serenity
confusion

laziness
nervousness

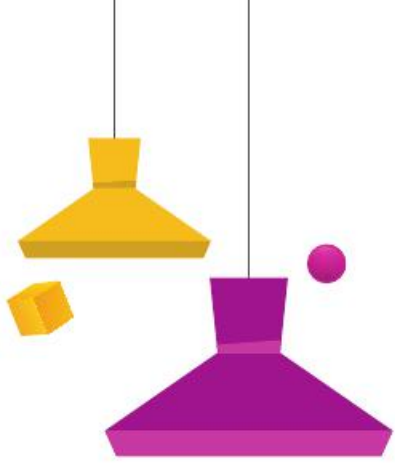
hysteria
apathy

Activity Time



- Discuss with your friends and write how will you plan 25th anniversary of your parents:

Writing Skills



15 Harry Pushed Her

Harry pushed her;
He pushed her around;
He pushed his sister.
Before school, after school;
On weekends.
He pushed his sister;
He had no friends.
He pushed her—school-holidays
And Christmas time.
The children always
Sang their made-up rhyme:
'Harry push her, push her now!
Harry push the crazy cow!'
Harry pushed her without **strain**:
Through snow, sunshine, wind and rain
She smiled strangely
And never said a word.
He pushed her for years—
It was so **absurd**.
Harry was twelve;



His sister twenty-three.
 Harry never had a childhood like me.
 Harry pushed her without a care;
 He pushed his sister in her wheelchair.

—Peter Thabit Jones

New Words to Learn



strain : worry or anxiety; **absurd** : very strange.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- What is the age of Harry's sister?
 (a) Twenty-one ☐ (b) Twenty-two ☐ (c) Twenty-three ☐
- Who is the poet?
 (a) Peter Drucker ☐ (b) Peter Janes ☐ (c) Peter Thabit Jones ☐
- What is the age of Harry?
 (a) Twelve ☐ (b) Eleven ☐ (c) Thirteen ☐
- To whom did Harry use to push in the wheelchair?
 (a) Brother ☐ (b) Sister ☐ (c) Friend ☐
- Who made a song for Harry?
 (a) His friends ☐ (b) His neighbours ☐ (c) His relatives ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

- Harry _____
 _____ around;
 _____ sister.
- His _____ .
 Harry never had _____ .
 Harry pushed _____ ;
 _____ her wheelchair.

C. Write the meaning of the words given below and then make their sentences on your own:

1. crazy _____ — _____
2. push _____ — _____
3. strain _____ — _____
4. absurd _____ — _____
5. rhyme _____ — _____

B. Answer the following questions:

Writing Skills

1. How was the Harry as a person?
2. Why the word 'pushed' had been used so many times in the poem?
3. What others used to think about Harry?
4. Why did the poet accustom the word 'Absurd'?
5. What all was Harry missing for pushing her sister who was in the wheelchair?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

Prefixes :

Analyse

Prefixes are small words or roots of words.

A Prefix can be placed before another word to modify its meaning and so build a new word.

Example: prepaid, uncomfortable, impossible, export, transport, forego.

The following are all negative prefixes.

in — im — ir — il —

Examples: indistinct, improbable, irreligious, illogical

When do we use each one of the negative prefixes above?

The prefix **in** — meaning not, becomes **im** — before the letter m, b or p, **ir** — before r, and **il** — before l.

• **Make negative of the following adjectives by adding in-, im-, ir- or il-**

practical	regular	responsible	legal
possible	consistent	religious	sufficient
legible	partial	direct	adequate
personal	balanced	mature	
	mobile		
	mortal		
	flexible		
	literate		
	definite		

Headlines

What is so funny about these newspaper headlines?

1. MANY ANTIQUES AT SENIOR CITIZENS' SALE.
2. COW SAVE A LIFE-Hauls farmer by tail from blazing building.
3. WOMAN DENIES COMMITTING SUICIDE.
4. BACHELORS PREFER BRAINS TO BEAUTY IN THEIR WIVES.
5. 20-YEAR FRIENDSHIP ENDS AT THE ALTAR.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- Match the **Column 'A'** with **Column 'B'** :

Critical Thinking

Column 'A'

1. to be at hand
2. to take something in hand
3. to get out of hand
4. to have time/money in hand
5. to keep one's hand in
6. to have one's hands full
7. to give someone a good hand
8. to be a handful
9. to be an old hand
10. to get the upper hand of something/someone

Column 'B'

- a. to have a lot of work
- b. to become out of control
- c. to be very near
- d. to win an advantage over it /him
- e. to be difficult to control
- f. to have it spare, left over to be used
- g. to take charge of it, manage it
- h. to be experienced at something
- i. to applaud someone for a good performance
- j. to keep in practice

Use the idioms in list A in sentences of your own.

LET'S WRITE

- Imagine that you are living in a foreign country. What kinds of things will you miss about home? Write an account detailing the sights, the smells, the noise, the people and anything else that you might miss and long for.

Writing Skills

Activity Time



- In a group of three or four write the recipes of any 2 dishes :

Creativity

Name of dish

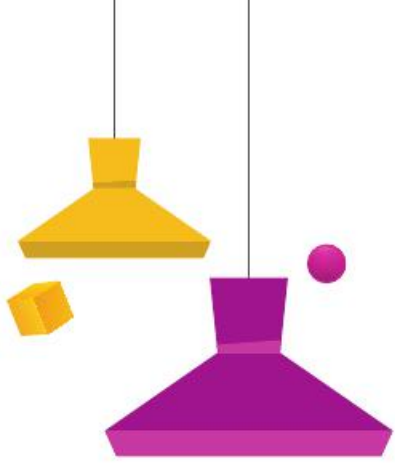
What is made of

1. _____

2. _____

Recipe of dish 1:

Recipe of dish 2:



16

How the Camel Got His Hump

In the beginning, when the world was new and the Animals were just beginning to work for Man there was a Camel, and he lived in the middle of a Howling Desert because he did not want to work. He ate sticks and thorns and prickles, and when anybody spoke to him he said, "Humph!" Just "Humph!" and no more. Presently the Horse came to him on Monday morning, with a saddle on his back and said, "Camel, O Camel, come out and trot like the rest of us."

"Humph!" said the Camel, and the Horse went away and told the Man.

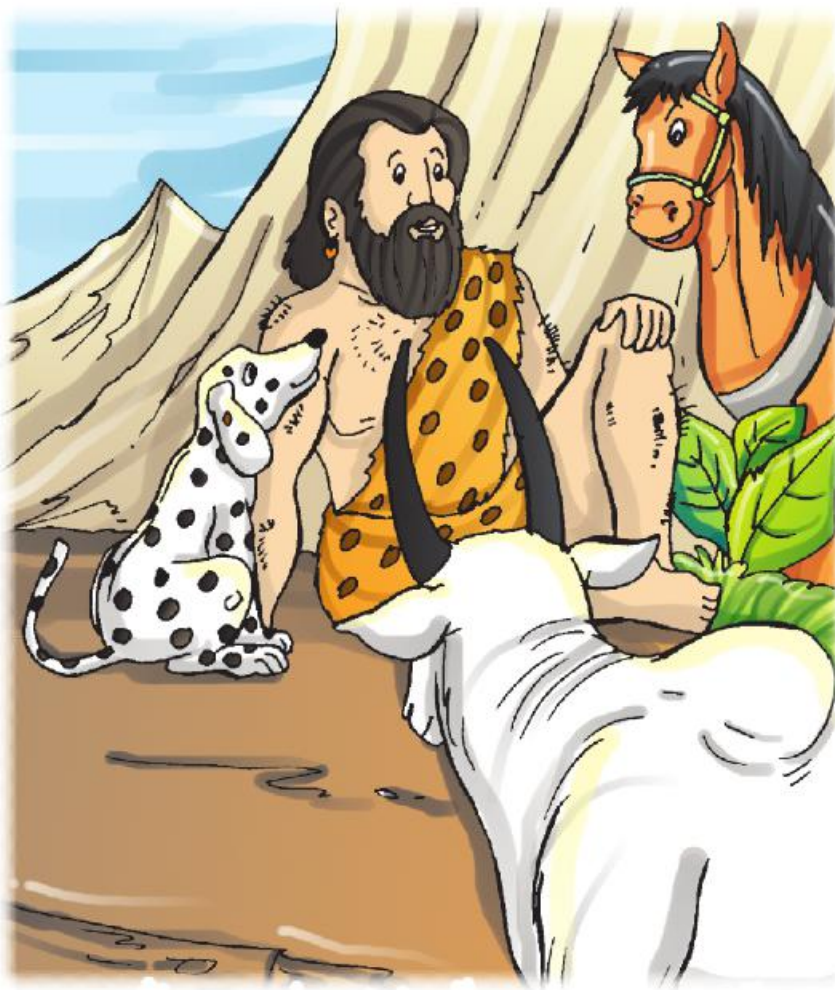
Presently the Dog came to him, with a stick in his mouth, and said, "Camel, O Camel, come and fetch and carry like the rest of us."



"Humph!" said the Camel, and the Dog went away and told the Man. Presently the Ox came to him with the yoke on his neck and said, "Camel, O Camel, come and plough like the rest of us."

"Humph!" said the Camel and the Ox went away and told the Man.

At the end of the day the Man called the Horse and the Dog and the Ox together, and said, "Three, O Three, I'm very sorry for you; but that Humph-thing in the Desert can't work, or he would have been hereby now, so I am going to leave him alone, and you must work double-time to make up for it."



That made the three very angry, and they held a Panchayat on the edge of the Desert, and the Camel came chewing cud and laughed at them. Then he said "Humph!" and went away again.

Presently there came along the Djinn who was incharge of all Deserts, rolling in a cloud of dust.

"Djinn of all Deserts," said the Horse, "right for anyone to be idle is it certainly not", said the Djinn, "Well", said the Horse, "there is a thing in the middle of your Desert with a long neck and long legs, and he hasn't done a stroke of work, since Monday morning. He would not trot."

"Whew!" said the Djinn whistling, "that's my Camel. What does he say about it?"

"He says Humph!" and he would not plough", said the Ox.

"Very good," said the Djinn. "I'll humph him if you will kindly wait a minute."

The Djinn rolled himself up in his dust-cloak, and took a walk across the desert and found the Camel looking at his own reflection in a pool of water.

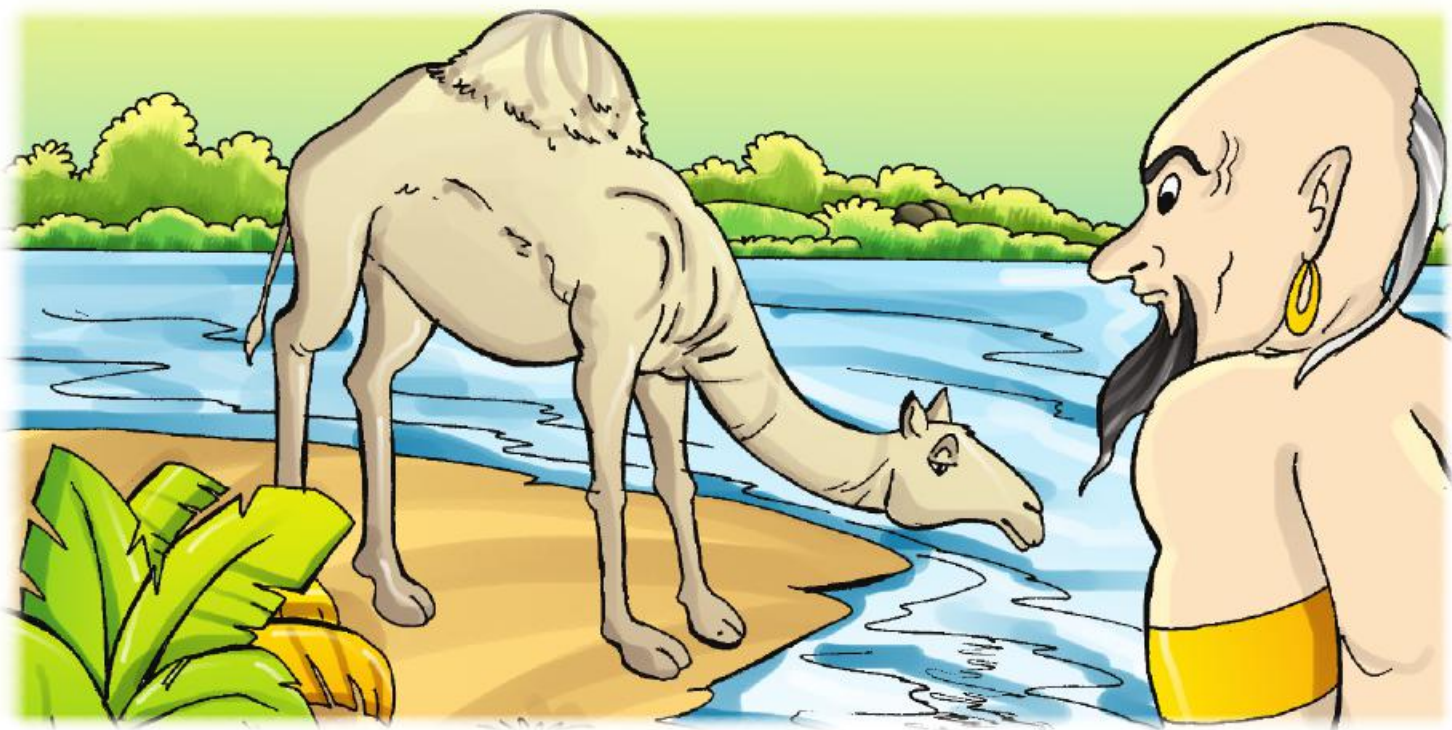
"My friend," said the Djinn, "What is this I hear of your doing no work?"

The Djinn sat down, with his chin in his hand, while the Camel looked at his own reflection in the pool of water."

"You have given the three extra work ever since Monday morning, all on account of your idleness," said the Djinn. And he went on thinking with his chin in his hand.

"Humph!" said the Camel.

"I should not say that again if I were you," said the Djinn, "you might say it once too often. I want you to work."



And the Camel said “Humph again, but no sooner had he said it than he saw his back, that he was so proud of, puffing up and puffing up into a great big hump.

“Do you see that?” said the Djinn. “That’s your very own humph that you have brought upon your very ownself by not working. Today is Thursday, and you have done no work since Monday, when the work began. Now you are going to work.”

“How can I,” said the Camel, “with this humph on my back?”

“That has a purpose,” said the Djinn, “all because you missed those three days. You will be able to work now for three days without eating, because you can live on your humph; and don’t you ever say I never did anything for you. Come out of the Desert and go to the Three and behave.”

And the Camel went away to join the Three. And from that day to this the Camel always wears a humph (we call it ‘hump’ now, not to hurt his feelings); but he has never yet caught up with the three days that he missed at the beginning of the world and he has never yet learned how to behave.

—Rudyard Kipling (*abridged*)

New Words to Learn



prickles : sharp points; **saddle** : leather seat on the back of an animal; **trot** : move fairly fast; **cud** : chew partly digested food again and again; **djinn** : a spirit that has strange powers and can assume any form, human or animal; **I’ll Humph him** : I’ll deal with him appropriately.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. For how many days camel had done no work?

(a) Three

(b) Four

(c) Five

2. Who is the author of the story?

(a) Charles Dickens

(b) Shakespeare

(c) Rudyard Kipling

3. Which animal do not want to work?

(a) Dog

(b) Camel

(c) Horse

4. What reply did camel use to give to the animals?

(a) Love you

(b) Humph

(c) Dumb

5. Who was the incharge of all Desert?

(a) Djinn

(b) Pjinn

(c) Tjinn

B. Fill in the blanks :

1. Monday morning with a _____ on his back.

2. The camel and the _____ went away and told the man.

3. Then he said _____ and went away again.

4. I'll _____ him if you will kindly wait a minute.

5. And he went on _____ with his chin in his hand.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

1. prickles

2. trot

3. cub

4. saddle

5. Djinn

Column 'B'

a. spirit

b. chew

c. leather seat

d. move fairly fast

e. sharp points

D. Answer the following questions:

1. Who were angry with the Camel?
2. What trick did Djinn play with the Camel?
3. Why did the Camel live in the middle of the desert?
4. Why was the Camel not working?
5. To whom three of them went to?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

- **Study this sentence.**

It stopped, (it) slid, (it) went down almost to the bottom.

In English we often leave out word (especially in conversation) when the meaning is understood from the context or from general knowledge.

Examples: The baby was drinking milk, the mother tea. The baby was drinking milk, the mother (was drinking) tea.

This is my new blue cycle. I bought it and then (I) wished I hadn't (bought it)

When using ellipses, the understood part of the verb must be the same as the expressed part. A singular verb cannot be made to do the service for an understood verb that is plural.

Example: His day **was** long and his hobbies many. (*wrong*)
 His days **were** long and his hobbies (were) many. (*correct*)
 His day **was** long and his hobbies were many. (*correct*).

- **Find out the mistakes in the following and correct them :**

1. I am going to the market but Meera not.
2. You are working hard but not your friend.
3. Sita is having roast chicken but the others vegetable curry.
4. Drawing and writing are good skills to learn, but scrawling not so good.
5. Chennai has been marked on the map but Rajapuram, Dinanagar and Pratappet left off.

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

- **Circle the silent letters in the following words :**

Critical Thinking

- i. calm ii. hymn iii. subtle iv. reign

example: high ('gh' is silent)

LET'S WRITE

- Write in pairs and read the following conversation. Provide your own short answers or comments in the blanks : Communication

A : It's going to be a long, hot summer.

B : Yes _____

A : I am going to try and go up to the hills.

B : So _____

A : I have been to Ooty and to Darjeeling, but never to Nainital.

B : Nor _____
I'd love to go there some day.

A : So _____

B : I've heard that it is a wonderful place for a holiday.

A : So _____ I read an article about it in the paper last week.

B : Yes, _____. It was a wonderful article, with photographs.

A : Yes, _____ I enjoyed reading it and am looking forward to seeing the place.

B : So _____ It might be a good idea to plan a trip there together some day.

A : It certainly _____

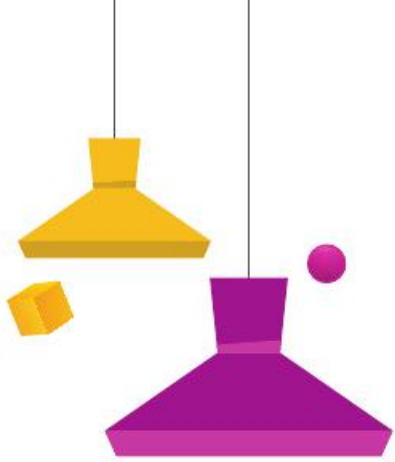
B : Let's do that.

Activity Time



- Write 5 facts you know about 'Camel' : Creativity

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____



17

The Summit Within

Of all the emotions which surged through me as I stood on the summit of Everest, looking over miles of panorama below us, the dominant one I think was humility. The physical in me seemed to say, “Thank God, its all over!” However, instead of being jubilant, there was a tinge of sadness. Was it because I had already done the ‘ultimate’ in climbing and there would be nothing higher to climb and all roads hereafter would lead down?

By climbing the **summit** of Everest you are overwhelmed by a deep sense of joy and thankfulness. It is a joy which lasts a lifetime. The experience changes you completely. The man who has been to the mountains is never the same again.

As I look back at life after climbing Everest I cannot help remarking about the other summit– the summit of the mind – no less formidable and no easier to climb.



Even when getting down from the summit once the physical exhaustion had gone, I began asking myself the question why I had climbed Everest. Why did the act of reaching the summit have such a hold on my imagination? It was already a thing of the past, something done yesterday. With every passing day, it would become more remote. And then what would remain? Would my memories fade slowly away?

All these thoughts led me to question myself as to why people climb mountains. It is not easy to answer the question. The simplest answer would be, as other have said, “Because it is there.” It presents great difficulties. Man takes delight in overcoming

obstacles. The obstacles in climbing a mountain are physical. A climb to a summit means **endurance**, persistence and will power. The demonstration of these physical qualities is no doubt exhilarating, as it was for me also.

I have a more personal answer to the question. From my childhood I have been attracted by mountains. I had been miserable, lost, when away from mountains, in the plains. Mountains are nature at its best. Their beauty and majesty pose a great challenge, and like many, I believe that mountains are a means of communion with God.

Once having granted this, the question remains: Why Everest? Because it is the highest, the mightiest and has defied many previous attempts. It takes the last ounce of one's energy. It is a **brutal** struggle with rock and ice. Once taken up, it cannot be given up halfway even when one's life is at stake. The passage back is as difficult as the passage onwards. And then, when the summit is climbed, there is the exhilaration, the joy of having done something, the sense of a battle fought and won. There is a feeling of victory and of happiness.

Glimpsing a peak in the distance, I get transported to another world. I experience a change within myself which can only be called mystical. By its beauty, aloofness, might, ruggedness, and the difficulties encountered on the way, the peak draws me to it—as Everest did. It is a challenge that is difficult to resist.

Looking back I find that I have not yet fully explained why I climbed Everest. It is like answering a question why you breathe. Why do you help your neighbour?

Why do you want to do good acts? There is no final answer possible. And then there is the fact that Everest is not just a physical climb. The man who has been to the mountain-top becomes conscious in a special manner of his own smallness in this large universe.



The physical conquest of a mountain is only one part of the achievement. There is more to it than that. It is followed by a sense of fulfilment. There is the satisfaction of a deep urge to rise above one's surroundings. It is the eternal love for adventure in man. The experience is not merely physical. It is emotional. It is spiritual.

Consider a typical climb, towards the summit on the last heights. You are sharing a rope with another climber. You firm in. He cuts the steps in the hard ice. Then he belays and you inch your way up. The climb is grim. You strain every nerve as you take every step. Famous climbers have left records of the help given by others. They have also recorded how they needed just that help. Else they might have given up. Breathing is difficult. You curse yourself for having let yourself in for this. You wonder why you ever undertook the ascent. There are moments when you feel like going back. It would be sheer, relief to go down, instead of up. But almost at once you snap out of that mood. There is something in you that does not let you give up the struggle. And you go on. Your companion keeps up with you just another fifty feet. Or a hundred, maybe. You ask yourself : Is there no end? You look at your companion and he looks at you. You draw inspiration from each other. And then without first being aware of it, you are at the summit.

Looking round from the summit you tell yourself that it was worthwhile. Other silvery peaks appear through the clouds. If you are lucky the sun may be on them. The



surrounding peaks look like a jewelled necklace around the neck of your summit. Below, you see vast valleys sloping into the distance. It is an **ennobling**, enriching, experience to just look down from the summit of a mountain. You bow down and make your obeisance to whichever God you worship.

I left on Everest a picture of Guru Nanak. Rawat left a picture of Goddess Durga. Phu Dorji left a **relic** of the Buddha. Edmund Hilary had buried a cross under a cairn (a heap of rocks and stones) in the snow. These are not symbols of conquest but of reverence.

The experience of having climbed to the summit changes you completely.

There is another summit. It is within yourself. It is in your own mind. Each man carries within himself his own mountain peak. He must climb it to reach to a fuller knowledge of himself. It is fearful, and unscalable. It cannot be climbed by anyone else. You yourself have to do it. The physical act of climbing to the summit of a mountain outside is akin to the act of climbing the mountain within. The effects of both the climbs are the same. Whether the mountain you climb is physical or emotional and spiritual the climb will certainly change you. It teaches you much about the world and about yourself.

I venture to think that my experience as an Everest climber has provided me with the inspiration to face life's ordeals resolutely. Climbing the mountain was a worthwhile experience. The conquest of the internal summit is equally worthwhile. The internal summit is, perhaps, higher than Everest.

—H.P.S. Ahluwalia

New Words to Learn



summit : the highest pointer part; **formidable** : causing fear; **endurance** : the fact of bearing pain; **brutal** : savage; **ennobling** : to elevate in degree excellence; **relic** : a surviving memorial of something past.



ASSIGNMENT



COMPREHENSION

A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Analytical Skills

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- The emotion that gripped him was one of :
 - victory over hurdles.
 - humility and a sense of smallness.
 - greatness and self importance.
- Standing on Everest, the writer was :
 - overjoyed.
 - very sad.
 - jubilant and sad.

☐
☐
☐

☐
☐
☐

3. "The summit of the mind" refers to :
 - (a) great intellectual achievements.
 - (b) the process of maturing mentally and spiritually.
 - (c) overcoming personal ambition for common welfare.



B. Fill in the blanks :

1. It is a joy which lasts a _____.
2. I have more personal _____ to the questions.
3. The _____ back is as difficult as the passage onwards.
4. The experience is not merely _____.
5. Else they might have _____ up.

C. Write a sentence against each of the following sentences. Your sentence should explain the statement. You can pick out sentences from the text and rewrite them. The first one has been done for you.

1. The experience changes you completely.
One who has been to the mountains is never the same again.
2. Mountains are nature at its least.

3. The going was difficult but the after effects were satisfying.

4. Man takes delight in overcoming obstacles.

5. The physical conquest of a mountain is really a spiritual experience.

D. Answer the following questions :

Writing Skills

1. What was it about Mount Everest that the author found irresistible?
2. One does not do it (climb a high peak) for fame alone. What does one do it for, really?
3. What are the three qualities that played a major role in the author's climb?
4. Why is adventure, which is risky, also pleasurable?
5. What, according to the writer, did his experience as an Everest climber teach him?
6. What were the 'symbols of reverence' left by members of the team on Everest?

LET'S LEARN GRAMMAR

A. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Analyse

Column 'A'

1. remote
2. means
3. dominant
4. formidable
5. overwhelmed

Column 'B'

- a. difficult to overcome
- b. most prominent
- c. be overcome/overpowered
- d. method (s)
- e. far away from

B. Write the noun form of the following words adding **-ance** or **-ence** to each :

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------|
| 1. endure _____ | 2. persist _____ |
| 3. signify _____ | 4. confide _____ |
| 5. maintain _____ | 6. abhor _____ |

BUILD YOUR VOCAB

• Look at the coloured phrases and their meanings given in brackets :

- (a) Mountains are nature **as its best**. (nature's best form and appearance)
- (b) Your life is **at risk**. (in danger you run the risk of losing your life.)
- (c) He was at **his best/worst** in the last meeting. (it was his best/worst performance)

Fill in the blanks in the following dialogues choosing suitable phrases from those given in the box :

Experiential Learning

at hand at once at all at a low cost at first sight

1. Teacher : You were away from school without permission. Go to the principal _____ and submit your explanation.
Pupil : Yes, Madam. But would you help me write it first?
2. Arun : Are you unwell?
Illa : No, not _____ why do you ask?
Arun : If you were unwell, I would send you to my uncle. He is a doctor.
3. Mary : Almost every Indian film has an episode of love _____.
David : Is that what makes them so popular in foreign countries?

4. Asif : You look depressed. Why are your spirits _____ today?
(Use such in the phrase)
- Ashok : I have to write ten sentences using words that I never heard before.
5. Shieba : Your big moment is close _____.
- Jyoti : How should I welcome it?
- Sheiba : Get up and receive the trophy.

LET'S WRITE

Write a composition describing a visit to the hills, or any place which you found beautiful and inspiring. Before writing, work in small groups. Discuss the points given below and decide if you want to use some of these points in your composition.

- **Consider this sentence**

Mountains are a means of communion with God.

Some composition may be read aloud to the entire class afterwards.

Activity Time



- Paste the three pictures of Mt. Everest :

Art Integration



Test Paper

1



A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- Who is author of the story 'No Longer Helpless'?
(a) Sonali Doshi ☐ (b) Sonali Kumar ☐ (c) Sonali Dewan ☐
- Which famous lake is in Odisha?
(a) Dal lake ☐ (b) Chilka lake ☐ (c) Sukhna lake ☐
- What is the age of Harry?
(a) Twelve ☐ (b) Eleven ☐ (c) Thirteen ☐
- What was the name of the queen?
(a) Queen Samaria ☐ (b) Queen Samantha ☐ (c) Queen Pearl ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

- I was lost, but _____ found me.
- Cambridge was my for _____ England it was strange.
- It is not like other district _____.
- She saw a _____ star in broad day light.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

- ngo
- grass root
- hamlet
- group dwellers
- pulse

Column 'B'

- keeping in touch
- persons who live together
- very small village
- ordinary people
- non-government organization

D. Answer the following questions :

- Who was Sadiq? What was his father's occupation?
- Why were king and queen sad?
- How was the Harry as a person?
- What was the Oldman ageless Wisdom?
- To whom was the writer eager to meet?



Test Paper

2



A. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) :

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- What is 'sardines'?
(a) It's a ship ☐ (b) Type of fish ☐ (c) Only (b) ☐
- Standing on Everest, the writer was :
(a) Overjoyed ☐ (b) Very sad ☐ (c) Jubilant ☐
- What kind of man was Mahatma Gandhi?
(a) Encouraging ☐ (b) Influential ☐ (c) Discouraging ☐
- What reply did camel use to give to the animals?
(a) Love you ☐ (b) Humph ☐ (c) Dumb ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

- Else they might have _____ up.
- He tells us that he was _____ not _____ as a dunce.
- Studying English is no _____ matter.
- Monday morning with a _____ on his back.

C. Match the Column 'A' with Column 'B' :

Column 'A'

- slay
- nay
- feeble
- stole up
- giant

Column 'B'

- great size
- weak
- came quietly without being noticed
- no
- kill

D. Answer the following questions :

- Why was the giant selfish?
- What is 'Tsunami'?
- What does the artist say he is painting?
- What were the "symbols of reverence" left by members of the team on Everest?
- How was the Mahatma Gandhi as a student?